



## Faculty & Staff Climate Survey: October 2025

### Introduction

The climate survey was administered to all full-time faculty and staff throughout the month of October. The purpose of this survey was to assess the climate and work environment for University employees and determine the extent to which they feel supported at the institution.

This survey, which was designed by the Senior Associate Provost and two psychology faculty members, was launched in response to increasing concerns about poor morale among faculty and staff. The survey was sent to 380 employees. Two hundred fifty completed the survey, representing a response rate of 66%.

The survey findings reported are organized into three sections: responses from all employees (faculty and staff); responses from faculty; and responses from staff. Responses to open-ended questions are included only in the sections dedicated to either faculty or staff. Each section has been bookmarked for easy reference.

### Demographic Information

| Which of the following best describes your role at the institution? | Responses | Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Faculty                                                             | 108       | 44.26%  |
| Staff                                                               | 131       | 53.69%  |
| Other (please specify)                                              | 5         | 2.05%   |
| Answered                                                            | 244       |         |
| Skipped                                                             | 6         |         |

| How many years have you been employed at Utica University? | Responses | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Less than one year                                         | 13        | 5.31%   |
| 1 - 4 years                                                | 63        | 25.71%  |
| 5 - 10 years                                               | 69        | 28.16%  |
| 11 - 15 years                                              | 40        | 16.33%  |
| 16 - 20 years                                              | 28        | 11.43%  |
| More than 20 years                                         | 32        | 13.06%  |
| Answered                                                   | 245       |         |
| Skipped                                                    | 5         |         |

## Summary of Findings

- Over half of all employees characterize the institution as welcoming, though fewer faculty than staff describe the University as a welcoming place.
- The majority of faculty and staff feel valued and supported by their departments, but not by the institution.
- The majority (81%) of respondents reported feeling respected by their colleagues. Slightly over half agreed/strongly agreed they felt respected by the Provost. Fewer reported feeling respected by the President or other senior administrators.
- A higher percentage of staff reported feeling respected by the President, Provost, and other senior administrators compared to faculty.
- Half of all respondents (faculty and staff) rate the institution's communication regarding important updates and changes as not so effective/not at all effective.
- Global email is the preferred method of communication.
- Seventy-two percent of faculty feel the University's leadership does not care about their well-being, compared to 41% of staff.
- Not feeling valued has the most adverse effect on employee morale, followed by salary and benefits. Salary and benefits have a greater impact on morale for staff than for faculty.

## I. Faculty & Staff Responses

| How would you characterize Utica University for faculty and staff? | Responses | Percent |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Almost always welcoming                                            | 45        | 18.15%  |
| Often welcoming                                                    | 97        | 39.11%  |
| Sometimes welcoming                                                | 76        | 30.65%  |
| Rarely welcoming                                                   | 23        | 9.27%   |
| Almost never welcoming                                             | 7         | 2.82%   |
| Answered                                                           | 248       |         |
| Skipped                                                            | 2         |         |

| How satisfied are you with the overall work environment at Utica University? | Responses | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                               | 15        | 6.07%   |
| Satisfied                                                                    | 78        | 31.58%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                           | 49        | 19.84%  |
| Dissatisfied                                                                 | 66        | 26.72%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                            | 39        | 15.79%  |
| Answered                                                                     | 247       |         |
| Skipped                                                                      | 3         |         |

| <b>How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by your department?</u></b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Highly valued                                                                        | 109              | 44.13%         |
| Valued                                                                               | 84               | 34.01%         |
| Neutral                                                                              | 37               | 14.98%         |
| Not valued                                                                           | 8                | 3.24%          |
| Not valued at all                                                                    | 9                | 3.64%          |
| Answered                                                                             | 247              |                |
| Skipped                                                                              | 3                |                |

| <b>How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by the institution?</u></b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Highly valued                                                                        | 16               | 6.48%          |
| Valued                                                                               | 52               | 21.05%         |
| Neutral                                                                              | 74               | 29.96%         |
| Not valued                                                                           | 68               | 27.53%         |
| Not valued at all                                                                    | 37               | 14.98%         |
| Answered                                                                             | 247              |                |
| Skipped                                                                              | 3                |                |

| <b>Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive <u>from your department?</u></b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Excellent                                                                                                     | 94               | 38.06%         |
| Good                                                                                                          | 92               | 37.25%         |
| Fair                                                                                                          | 44               | 17.81%         |
| Poor                                                                                                          | 10               | 4.05%          |
| Vey poor                                                                                                      | 7                | 2.83%          |
| Answered                                                                                                      | 247              |                |
| Skipped                                                                                                       | 3                |                |

| <b>Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive <u>from the institution?</u></b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Excellent                                                                                                     | 13               | 5.26%          |
| Good                                                                                                          | 54               | 21.86%         |
| Fair                                                                                                          | 70               | 28.34%         |
| Poor                                                                                                          | 66               | 26.72%         |
| Vey poor                                                                                                      | 44               | 17.81%         |
| Answered                                                                                                      | 247              |                |
| Skipped                                                                                                       | 3                |                |

| To what extent do you agree with the following statements?                                              | Strongly agree | Agree  | Neither agree nor disagree | Disagree | Strongly disagree |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------|----------------------------|----------|-------------------|
| The institution encourages you to have a voice and express concerns openly.                             | 8.13%          | 32.92% | 26.42%                     | 21.13%   | 11.38%            |
| The institution provides you with opportunities to share thoughts and feelings about issues of concern. | 7.28%          | 39.27% | 25.91%                     | 17.00%   | 10.52%            |
| I feel respected by the University President.                                                           | 11.42%         | 27.75% | 24.08%                     | 14.28%   | 22.45%            |
| I feel respected by the University Provost.                                                             | 14.97%         | 36.43% | 27.53%                     | 10.12%   | 10.93%            |
| I feel respected by other senior administrators.                                                        | 9.34%          | 32.52% | 33.73%                     | 15.44%   | 8.94%             |
| I feel respected by my colleagues.                                                                      | 29.15%         | 51.82% | 8.90%                      | 7.69%    | 2.43%             |
| My work responsibilities are clearly defined.                                                           | 19.83%         | 46.56% | 11.74%                     | 16.19%   | 5.67%             |
| My workload is manageable.                                                                              | 11.38%         | 31.70% | 21.95%                     | 23.58%   | 11.38%            |
| I have the resources needed to do my job effectively.                                                   | 4.86%          | 25.91% | 23.48%                     | 30.77%   | 14.98%            |
| I often feel stressed or overwhelmed at work.                                                           | 28.34%         | 31.98% | 18.22%                     | 15.38%   | 6.07%             |

| How effective is the institution's communication regarding important updates and changes? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                       | 8         | 3.24%   |
| Very effective                                                                            | 27        | 10.93%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                        | 87        | 35.22%  |
| Not so effective                                                                          | 75        | 30.36%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                      | 50        | 20.24%  |
| Answered                                                                                  | 247       |         |
| Skipped                                                                                   | 3         |         |

| What are your preferred methods of communication? (Check all that apply.) | Responses | Response Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------|
| Global emails                                                             | 195       | 79.59%           |
| Morning Mention                                                           | 86        | 35.10%           |
| Communications from various affiliate groups (e.g., AAUP, PSAC)           | 102       | 41.63%           |
| Discussions with supervisor, department, or school                        | 186       | 75.92%           |
| 1:1 meeting with a member of the University's senior leadership           | 75        | 30.61%           |
| Small group discussions with administrative offices or senior leadership. | 123       | 50.20%           |
| Answered                                                                  | 245       |                  |
| Skipped                                                                   | 5         |                  |

| How effective is the University's President when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                           | 11        | 4.49%   |
| Very effective                                                                                                | 51        | 20.82%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                            | 69        | 28.16%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                              | 56        | 22.86%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                          | 58        | 23.67%  |
| Answer                                                                                                        | 245       |         |
| Skipped                                                                                                       | 5         |         |

| How effective is the University's Provost when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                         | 19        | 7.82%   |
| Very effective                                                                                              | 62        | 25.51%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                          | 92        | 37.86%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                            | 44        | 18.11%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                        | 26        | 10.70%  |
| Answered                                                                                                    | 243       |         |
| Skipped                                                                                                     | 7         |         |

| To what extent do you feel the University's leadership team cares about your well-being? | Response | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|
| A great deal                                                                             | 9        | 3.64%   |
| A lot                                                                                    | 28       | 11.34%  |
| A moderate amount                                                                        | 72       | 29.15%  |
| A little                                                                                 | 64       | 25.91%  |
| None at all                                                                              | 74       | 29.96%  |
| Answered                                                                                 | 247      |         |
| Skipped                                                                                  | 3        |         |

| How satisfied are you with the professional development opportunities available at the institution? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                                                      | 4         | 1.62%   |
| Satisfied                                                                                           | 35        | 14.17%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                                                  | 84        | 34.01%  |
| Dissatisfied                                                                                        | 76        | 30.77%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                                                   | 48        | 19.43%  |
| Answered                                                                                            | 247       |         |
| Skipped                                                                                             | 3         |         |

| How much of an impact does each of the following have on your morale? | A great deal | Much   | Some   | Slight | Not at all |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------|--------|--------|------------|
| Salary                                                                | 47.78%       | 21.46% | 23.48% | 4.86%  | 2.43%      |
| Benefits                                                              | 43.72%       | 26.32% | 22.27% | 4.45%  | 3.24%      |
| Feelings of belonging                                                 | 35.92%       | 35.51% | 19.59% | 4.08%  | 4.89%      |
| Feeling valued                                                        | 56.91%       | 29.67% | 8.94%  | 2.03%  | 2.44%      |
| Workload                                                              | 40.08%       | 25.50% | 24.69% | 5.66%  | 4.05%      |
| Staffing levels                                                       | 40.89%       | 27.94% | 22.67% | 6.07%  | 2.43%      |
| Resources (e.g., systems, software, departmental budget)              | 33.19%       | 31.98% | 24.29% | 8.09%  | 2.43%      |
| Facilities                                                            | 16.59%       | 26.32% | 33.19% | 14.97% | 8.90%      |
| Institutional policies and procedures                                 | 22.22%       | 31.28% | 31.69% | 10.28% | 4.53%      |

| Approximately how long have your concerns affected your morale? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Less than 6 months                                              | 18        | 7.76%   |
| 6 months to 1 year                                              | 32        | 13.79%  |
| 1 to 2 years                                                    | 56        | 24.14%  |
| 2-3 years                                                       | 39        | 16.81%  |
| 3 to 4 years                                                    | 27        | 11.64%  |
| 4 to 5 years                                                    | 26        | 11.21%  |
| More than 5 years                                               | 34        | 14.66%  |
| Answered                                                        | 232       |         |
| Skipped                                                         | 18        |         |

## II. Faculty Responses

| How would you characterize Utica University for faculty and staff? | Responses | Percent |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Almost always welcoming                                            | 16        | 14.81%  |
| Often welcoming                                                    | 35        | 32.41%  |
| Sometimes welcoming                                                | 33        | 30.56%  |
| Rarely welcoming                                                   | 17        | 15.74%  |
| Almost never welcoming                                             | 7         | 6.48%   |

| How satisfied are you with the overall work environment at Utica University? | Responses | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                               | 4         | 3.74%   |
| Satisfied                                                                    | 25        | 23.36%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                           | 14        | 3.08%   |
| Dissatisfied                                                                 | 32        | 29.91%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                            | 32        | 29.91%  |

| How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by your department?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Highly valued                                                                 | 53        | 49.53%  |
| Valued                                                                        | 30        | 28.04%  |
| Neutral                                                                       | 17        | 15.89%  |
| Not valued                                                                    | 2         | 1.87%   |
| Not valued at all                                                             | 5         | 4.67%   |

| How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by the institution?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Highly valued                                                                 | 8         | 7.41%   |
| Valued                                                                        | 16        | 14.81%  |
| Neutral                                                                       | 28        | 25.93%  |
| Not valued                                                                    | 33        | 30.56%  |
| Not valued at all                                                             | 23        | 21.30%  |

| Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive <u>from your department?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Excellent                                                                                              | 40        | 37.74%  |
| Good                                                                                                   | 37        | 34.91%  |
| Fair                                                                                                   | 21        | 19.81%  |
| Poor                                                                                                   | 4         | 3.77%   |
| Very poor                                                                                              | 4         | 3.77%   |

| Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive from the institution? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Excellent                                                                                       | 5         | 4.63%   |
| Good                                                                                            | 17        | 15.74%  |
| Fair                                                                                            | 25        | 23.25%  |
| Poor                                                                                            | 29        | 26.85%  |
| Very poor                                                                                       | 32        | 29.63%  |

| To what extent do you agree with the following statements?                                              | Strongly agree | Agree  | Neither agree nor disagree | Disagree | Strongly disagree |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------|----------------------------|----------|-------------------|
| The institution encourages you to have a voice and express concerns openly.                             | 7.48%          | 26.17% | 19.63%                     | 25.23%   | 21.50%            |
| The institution provides you with opportunities to share thoughts and feelings about issues of concern. | 8.49%          | 30.19% | 22.64%                     | 21.70%   | 16.98%            |
| I feel respected by the University President.                                                           | 8.57%          | 16.19% | 17.14%                     | 17.14%   | 40.95%            |
| I feel respected by the University Provost.                                                             | 15.09%         | 32.08% | 19.81%                     | 12.26%   | 20.75%            |
| I feel respected by other senior administrators.                                                        | 8.49%          | 23.58% | 32.08%                     | 19.81%   | 16.04%            |
| I feel respected by my colleagues.                                                                      | 29.25%         | 48.11% | 9.43%                      | 10.38%   | 2.83%             |
| My work responsibilities are clearly defined.                                                           | 16.19%         | 46.67% | 11.43%                     | 19.05%   | 6.67%             |
| My workload is manageable.                                                                              | 9.62%          | 25.96% | 22.12%                     | 26.92%   | 15.38%            |
| I have the resources needed to do my job effectively.                                                   | 4.67%          | 17.76% | 20.56%                     | 35.51%   | 21.50%            |
| I often feel stressed or overwhelmed at work.                                                           | 40.57%         | 29.25% | 11.32%                     | 10.38%   | 8.49%             |

| How effective is the institution's communication regarding important updates and changes? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                       | 3         | 2.80%   |
| Very effective                                                                            | 7         | 6.54%   |
| Somewhat effective                                                                        | 26        | 24.30%  |
| Not so effective                                                                          | 33        | 30.84%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                      | 38        | 35.51%  |

| What are your preferred methods of communication? (Check all that apply.) | Responses | Response Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|------------------|
| Global emails                                                             | 87        | 25.43%           |
| Morning Mention                                                           | 28        | 8.18%            |
| Communications from various affiliate groups (e.g., AAUP, PSAC)           | 51        | 14.91%           |
| Discussions with supervisor, department, or school                        | 81        | 23.68%           |
| 1:1 meeting with a member of the University's senior leadership           | 36        | 10.52%           |
| Small group discussions with administrative offices or senior leadership. | 59        | 17.25%           |



| How effective is the University's President when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                           | 0         | 0.00%   |
| Very effective                                                                                                | 13        | 12.15%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                            | 19        | 17.76%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                              | 31        | 28.97%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                          | 44        | 41.12%  |

| How effective is the University's Provost when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                         | 6         | 5.61%   |
| Very effective                                                                                              | 20        | 18.69%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                          | 36        | 33.64%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                            | 26        | 24.30%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                        | 19        | 17.76%  |

| To what extent do you feel the University's leadership team cares about your well-being? | Response | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|
| A great deal                                                                             | 2        | 39.81%  |
| A lot                                                                                    | 7        | 6.48%   |
| A moderate amount                                                                        | 21       | 19.44%  |
| A little                                                                                 | 35       | 32.41%  |
| None at all                                                                              | 43       | 39.81%  |

| How satisfied are you with the professional development opportunities available at the institution? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                                                      | 2         | 1.87%   |
| Satisfied                                                                                           | 17        | 15.89%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                                                  | 34        | 31.78%  |
| Dissatisfied                                                                                        | 33        | 30.84%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                                                   | 21        | 19.63%  |

| How much of an impact does each of the following have on your morale? | A great deal | Much   | Some   | Slight | Not at all |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------|--------|--------|------------|
| Salary                                                                | 40.57%       | 18.87% | 27.36% | 9.43%  | 3.77%      |
| Benefits                                                              | 31.13%       | 26.42% | 30.19% | 7.55%  | 4.72%      |
| Feelings of belonging                                                 | 41.90%       | 33.3%  | 18.10% | 3.81%  | 2.86%      |
| Feeling valued                                                        | 63.55%       | 28.97% | 3.74%  | 0.93%  | 2.80%      |
| Workload                                                              | 48.57%       | 23.81% | 20.95% | 1.90%  | 4.76%      |
| Staffing levels                                                       | 34.91%       | 26.42% | 27.36% | 7.55%  | 3.77%      |

| How much of an impact does each of the following have on your morale? | A great deal | Much   | Some   | Slight | Not at all |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------|--------|--------|------------|
| Resources (e.g., systems, software, departmental budget)              | 31.78%       | 34.58% | 22.43% | 9.35%  | 1.87%      |
| Facilities                                                            | 19.63%       | 29.91% | 31.78% | 7.48%  | 11.21%     |
| Institutional policies and procedures                                 | 26.67%       | 34.29% | 26.67% | 6.67%  | 2.86%      |

### Other Circumstances Impacting Morale

- Many of the categories mentioned above have shifted over time. One of the reasons working in academia is highly valued is the access to an interesting and supportive work environment. This includes being valued and feeling that we are appropriately staffed to provide excellent service. At the moment, we are not doing these well. We choose to work here in spite of the lack of resources. When the auxiliary & foundational reasons have been eroded, we have lost the ability to serve our core reasons for existence. The general constituency of staff and faculty are quickly losing faith in our ability to persevere.
- The identity of the school has changed since I got here, and that process did not include faculty, nor was it transparent.
- complete disrespect by the Board of Trustees; Institutional leadership promoting from within in some cases when the person is not qualified; faculty failure to understand how lowering standards weakens the institution and disrespects those who meet required standards.
- The institutional culture does not seem to acknowledge that we are a university, but rather feels like a poorly run business. Faculty and student accomplishments are rarely acknowledged and never celebrated, the halls and classrooms are bare and sterile and lacking personality. Further, senior leadership is aloof, distant, and incompetent; they lie to faculty and students or intentionally obfuscate the truth and refuse to share essential information regarding the financial conditions at the institution. Mismanagement appears to be widespread among senior leadership.
- Transparency and honesty
- Clear and timely communication, with a genuine ability to provide input on policies that affect me. No more appointed committees of faculty whose views I don't share and who do not feel obligated to consult with and represent stakeholders.
- Opportunities for development (teaching, scholarships, etc)
- Accountability
- Onboarding and Mentorship do not exist, no support at all from anyone as to where to begin, what to do, how to do it, who to contact, the IT resources, where supplies are located, how I can get books, where student resources are located, how a day flows, when to grade, how to grade, rubrics, access to courses, empty shells of canvas opened the day

of the course beginning with no resources to teach the course including no books, ebooks, examsoft questions, powerpoints, case studies, etc. Feeling VERY overwhelmed and as if the institution does not care about my wellbeing, that all I am here for is to have successful student outcomes and to "push" students through the program for financial gain to the institution and complete burnout of myself. This is without lack of trying to seek support, mentorship, and guidance from my peers, leadership and HR, also a possible loss of Flex time which is why I took this position. It is incredibly hard to come to work everyday in this environment

- Hope for the future comes with seeing a path forward. The amount of uncertainty we are living with has a huge impact.
- Please note, I have marked things as having a great deal of an effect on my morale, but the question does not indicate a direction. These things have a profoundly negative effect on my morale.
- Doing everything right (teaching tutorials, extra support for students) and still being punished (reduced budgets/salary; fewer resources for students) while administration continues to get rewarded
- The combination of all the above probably has a greater impact than any one individual aspect. Buildings get old, but the lack of working blinds in faculty offices, for example, feels more and more like an example of how we are not valued rather than just a sign of aging facilities.
- Student success - A great deal
- admin's concern for students' basic needs
- I have no confidence in senior leadership's responses during meetings, which takes morale.
- This used to be a fun place to work. Laura Casamento wrung every last penny out of that that she could, and left an empty husk. Todd promised it would be fun again, but that was a lie. I say "lie", not "delusion" or "fantasy" because he has methodically and intentionally made it a (pardon my French) shittier and shittier place to work, so I can't believe he ever meant it. There is really not much else to keep people here besides the students, and even they are leaving.
- A culture of excellence (rather than a culture of mediocrity) is important for my morale
- Cutting 30 jobs and related programs at once is terrible . Why wasn't done more gradually? While COVID-19 was unforeseeable, the rest of the expansion in FL and downtown was a huge misstep and Utica is paying the price for it now.
- Staffing, orientation
- Out of the public schools I have worked at as well as the other institutions of higher learning, Utica University has offered me the best teaching experience so far.
- Other faculty's feelings as expressed to me. Morale, both high and low, is catching.

- Communications with incomplete or self-contradictory information really create doubt about the competence of the President and some of the Vice-presidents, and this really has negative effects on my morale.

| Approximately how long have your concerns affected your morale? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Less than 6 months                                              | 6         | 5.88%   |
| 6 months to 1 year                                              | 9         | 8.83%   |
| 1 to 2 years                                                    | 22        | 21.57%  |
| 2-3 years                                                       | 18        | 17.65%  |
| 3 to 4 years                                                    | 13        | 12.75%  |
| 4 to 5 years                                                    | 13        | 12.75%  |
| More than 5 years                                               | 21        | 20.59%  |

**Please share any additional comments regarding the current climate at Utica University.**

- I learned a long time ago at another institution that more voices at the table results in a better solution. It's very messy, but the outcome is ALWAYS better. I also learned that I could live with outcomes I didn't agree with if I felt I had been sincerely listened to from the beginning. Our administration, including the Board of Trustees, has been sidelining constituent groups for a long time. They appear to cherry pick the voices they want to listen to and promote that as if every group has had the opportunity to provide input. Also, it's disingenuous to say that we should not consider financial issues. This is not a new problem at Utica U. There have been several rounds of freezes, reductions, and cuts stretching back more than 5-10 years. Yes, this is the worst so far, but it does affect morale coupled with the other stuff.
- I am tired of messages from the administration that are simply a fiat with no rationale given. A big example was the entire COVID situation. IITS and faculty rallied to make it work, and we got edicts with no attempt to inform leading to students making poor decisions and woefully disrupting learning.
- I think transparency is important. Giving opportunities for faculty and staff to be and feel heard can be helpful, but it needs to be balanced; complaint sessions are not inspiring.
- From my perspective, the current abysmal faculty morale has 3 major sources and this survey did a poor job of allowing me to express that: 1) The Trustees don't seem to understand what the University is and how best to manage it. While almost every position at the school is essential, the ultimate reason why students go to university is to learn from professors. We are not petulant children; we are (mostly) highly educated professionals who think deeply about the institution and how to defend and improve it.

We (mostly) have the connection with students and know what they need and want. When faculty offer real, reasoned concerns or ideas don't reject them and don't allow the administration to reject them without understanding them. The whitewashing of previous middle-states reports not only occurred but when faculty brought it up, they were told that the Board didn't want to hear what we had to say. I blame the Board for the current state of affairs. Their failure to be open to input from those who know the institution best is foolhardy. 2) hiring, promotion, and retention of administrators who are not qualified. We have been employing the admissions strategy that I learned about in the 1990s without any significant change to adapt to the times. I'm pleased that we have someone new in admissions but we have retained senior administrators who only have jobs here because they were friends with other senior administrators, not because they have the skills that we need them to have. Hiring from within is fine during emergencies or when we truly have the best candidate in house but there is far too much inbreeding here. We need fresh ideas. When someone is still using the same techniques decades after being hired and learning those techniques here, they really have no value to us. We need the best. This will typically come from outside. If you have a faulty admissions scheme or marketing scheme that you learned here as an employee decades ago, you will never be able to help us with fresh ideas. 3) We have a broken system for election to senate committees and evaluation of faculty. Weak faculty can be elected to committees and undermine the maintenance of faculty quality. I hate to think the worst by my interpretation is that weak faculty tend to vote to tenure and promote weak faculty because then there will be lots of weak faculty and they won't look bad. These weak faculty have completely undermined the process and are turning us into a community college in terms of the quality of the faculty. Presidents past have also done the same thing, overriding committee decisions that did not recommend tenure or promotion, for good reasons. Keeping weak faculty weakens the institution and is demoralizing for faculty who are working exceedingly hard to meet or exceed the standards of real faculty. 3) The faculty union promotes weakness in faculty. Recent leadership in the union has done everything in their power to loosen rigor and to eliminate demands on faculty scholarship and quality. They seem bent on going to war to defend faculty who should not be retained. Doing so prevents us from hiring the correct person for the job and undermines quality and morale. The union also presents take-it-or-leave-it contracts with no ability to fix serious problems without rejecting the entire contract. In this way, our contracts become the desired outcomes of the governing board and may not be reflective of what most faculty want or need, beyond the obvious fight for salary and benefits. They even lash out at departments for wanting to work hard on departmental projects. The prohibition of work in the summer/winter breaks is not who we are as faculty except for the faculty who have checked out already. the faculty are in a death spiral of their own making but that has been greatly accelerated by the misguided efforts of the union to protect faculty from work.

- I feel valued until I am not valued; I feel respected until I am not respected; I feel my work load is manageable until it becomes not manageable. I pretty much lost any faith I had in our leadership when Laura was appointed president.
- There are MANY reasons the current climate is down, right now: staff/faculty/budget cuts, declining enrollment, threat of closure, and administration not (and understandably not often able to be) as transparent as people want them to be. This is a painful period in Utica's history right now. The president and senior leadership are in an unpopular position regardless. They have to make the necessary cuts to keep the BUSINESS afloat, or not, and watch the institution fold and be the ones that let it happen. I assume there's a lot not being shared with faculty and staff...I also know there has to be. As far as I can see, you ARE taking the steps to make this work, unpopular as they may be for many.
- Climate is secretive, not transparent. Individuals feel they are told one thing only to have it completely reversed.
- It is disheartening to be one of the largest programs at the institution, with the expectation to "grow", yet faculty positions are not posted when individuals depart the university AND we are slated to have 3 positions retrenched. The university claims they will "reallocate resources to programs that attract and enroll the majority of students". There has been no evidence of this.
- Senior leadership has been begged for YEARS to address morale and wellness but remain indifferent, even working to heighten a sense of uncertainty and despair among the faculty.
- My working environment is emotionally heavy, stressful and challenging because it's defined by employment insecurity and resource scarcity resulting from financial decisions beyond my control.
- Morale is low. We are all being stretched to our limits...asking to do more with less. This type of situation is not sustainable long-term.
- This survey did not ask about the Board of Trustees. As a key stakeholder, it seems that should have been included, especially since the final decisions rest with them and because they do communicate with the faculty on occasion. Given the chairperson of the Board of Trustees wrote a letter to the faculty (pasted below), calling the AAUP-Utica President "Ms. Fleming" (she's has a PhD) while correctly calling the University President Dr. Pfannestiel, it seems the Board of Trustees is also an important component of the morale at Utica University. This isn't the first time the Board of Trustees has written offensive and threatening communications to the faculty directly. During 2022-2023 the Board of Trustees did as well. They are also currently censured by the faculty senate. It is also worth noting that Mr. Thurston's letter from September 8 was in response to the faculty and librarians asking the Board of Trustees to please be transparent with the community. It was also related to our concerns that the University violated federal SEC laws as well as committed insider trading (I'm unable to upload screenshots but you can

see the trade on EMMA that was made between the Board of Trustees June 20, 2025 resolution declaring financial exigency and the July 1, 2025 public announcement of mass firings). It isn't lost on the faculty that the current Chair of the Board of Trustees, in 2016, "agreed to pay \$5 million, plus interest, to resolve allegations that its chairman and chief executive officer, Gary Thurston, its president, Jeremy Thurston, employees, Ralph Bennett and Steve Benedict and Hayner Hoyt affiliates LeMoyne Interiors and Doyner Inc., engaged in conduct designed to exploit contracting opportunities reserved for service-disabled veterans." (<https://www.justice.gov/archives/opa/pr/hayner-hoyt-corporation-pay-5-million-resolve-false-claims-act-liability>). There is much much more one could write to respond to this question, but explaining the corruption at the top seems to be the most paramount, so I will leave it at that. Here is a copy of the letter the Mr. Thurston sent on September 8, 24 hours before 31 notices of retrenchment were issued to faculty across the university, many of those faculty have been here for decades, and the letters informing them of being laid off had no humanity or care at all. I've seen how other universities handle crises and austerity, and they do so with humanity and concern as well as ensure they are careful with every step. Utica University did not do that. Their decisions, even firing faculty who have been here for decades, was done in a sloppy manner, riddled with errors, clearly not thought through, and the University leadership could not and still can not answer any basic questions about the current financial situation at Utica or anything about the future. They are so uninformed and over their heads, YET refuse to respect faculty enough to let us help, it is gut wrenching to watch. Observing the university leadership over the past year has been a lesson in how to close a college in 12 months, a lesson none of us ever wanted, but have been forced to watch firsthand, dying to help, yet being prevented from doing so. THAT is what has killed morale more than anything. The fact that we want to help, and no one cares. Jeremy Thurston's September 8, 2025 Letter Sent to the Entire Full-Time Faculty (filled with many, many falsehoods):

September 8, 2025 Ms. Leonore Fleming President, AAUP-Utica/AFT 6786 Utica University 1600 Burrstone Road Utica, NY 13502 Re: Resolution to Rescind Retrenchment Dear Ms. Fleming; President Pfannestiel shared with me the Resolution prepared by the AAUP directing the Utica University Board of Trustees to rescind the Notice of Retrenchment delivered to the AAUP on July 1, 2025. I understand you sent it to Ms. Heidi Hoeller on August 29, 2025, as well and she also forwarded it to me. Although I very much appreciate the concerns shared by the University Faculty, the decision made by the Board of Trustees to direct President Pfannestiel to issue the financially exigent notice of retrenchment was not a decision that was made without significant deliberation and review of the University's current enrollment outlook, finances, and the state of academia more globally. After reviewing your resolution with some executive committee members from the Board of Trustees, we respectfully decline your request to rescind the notice of retrenchment and will not bring it to a vote. I have shared it with the rest of the board for their information. I would like to be candid and



direct with you and hope you will take a few minutes to really reflect on these words; there is no avoiding the need to permanently reduce the University's expenditures to preserve its future. Salaries and benefits are the largest expense the University has, and the faculty salary and benefit expense is that of an institution with considerably higher enrollment. With the enrollment demographic cliff now upon Utica University and all other institutions of higher education, there is no path to simply grow our way out of these financial challenges—particularly in New York State, where the enrollment declines may be precipitous. This is basic economics; if expenses exceed revenue year over year, then the business or institution will not survive once its cash is depleted. The board fully appreciates the unpleasantness of eliminating positions, but it is our duty to preserve the majority of jobs at Utica University, both staff and faculty, and we must make permanent changes immediately. You represent all full-time faculty of Utica University and with that comes great responsibility. By not working collaboratively and amicably with the University Administration on a plan to make the structural changes necessary and cooperating with this defined process in the collective bargaining agreement, you are not saving positions, you are placing more positions in jeopardy. The more time that elapses without realizing savings, the deeper the cuts need to be to realize the savings during the remainder of the fiscal year. This is the same thing that happened in the 2024-2025 fiscal year. President Pfannestiel initially approached the AAUP on April 29, 2024, to discuss temporary reductions in salary and benefits to close a budget gap with the University. It took until December 16, 2024, to agree on these temporary reductions. Had the AAUP leadership worked quickly and efficiently with the University Administration, the temporary reductions would have been far less impactful during each pay period for the faculty than they ultimately were. You mention a lack of transparency from the University, and I would like to address that. At the May 8, 2025, board meeting where you were present, I specifically stated in my opening remarks, "We still have some difficult work ahead to continue to restructure the University to support the enrollment numbers we are projecting to see moving forward." President Pfannestiel further stated in his remarks that while much good work had been accomplished in 2024-2025 to address the institution's financial challenges that these were "one-off" sacrifices, and that to position the university for stability and moderate growth permanent structural changes to the business model were necessary. We also presented the 2025-2026 budget where we showed a reduction in faculty salaries and benefits to which [Name], representing AAUP at the board meeting, stood and asked how the faculty salaries and benefits were going to be reduced after the temporary cuts were reinstated. President Pfannestiel reiterated that personnel cost reductions are necessary to achieve the budget surplus we must achieve in the 2025-2026 fiscal year. After the May Trustee meeting, Dr. Pfannestiel met with the AAUP leadership on June 5, 2025, to discuss the need to permanently reduce faculty expenses and ask for help to develop a plan to ensure our expenses were consistent with our enrollment revenues. President Pfannestiel specifically advised the AAUP that if



action wasn't taken, the Board of Trustees would have no choice but to move forward with financial exigent retrenchment per the collective bargaining agreement. This is what happened. Contrary to the language in your proposed resolution, the University has been abundantly transparent with AAUP leadership. Utica University can and will have a bright future and move forward prosperously when we make the necessary changes to reduce our expenditures to match our enrollment numbers. Anything less than that will cause the University to fall victim to the same fate as Cazenovia College, Wells College, College of St. Rose, and so many others. At convocation, I saw numerous faculty members wearing pins that said, "SAVE UTICA." That is what the Board of Trustees and the Administration are trying to do. I believe this is what you want as well; so I hope we can work together to save the majority of the faculty positions at the University and preserve the University's future. Thank you. Jeremy Thurston, '00 Chairperson Utica University Board of Trustees Cc: Utica University Board of Trustees Utica University Administration Utica University Faculty

- I have felt for the past 6 years or so like I'm in a constant state of emergency at work. I'm asked to put out a fire with the threat that if I don't put time and energy that I don't have IMMEDIATELY into this problem, life and work as I know it will cease. It was the need to revise Gen Ed in a pandemic. It was the almost immediate "portfolio review" when our new Gen Ed had barely gotten off the ground (same semester it started), which then distracted and worried a huge number of the faculty -- largely those who had just or were still laboring to revise our courses to meet the revised Gen Ed. (Those curriculum proposals were no joke and added to already overloaded workload and exhaustion! Again, most pressing for the same faculty affected by program cuts.) New Gen Ed director; New Gen Ed director leaves; replacement search fails; Gen Ed committee doesn't meet, so everything is in flux; new government: Provost says we will be deliberate in responding to any changes in policy from the fed. govt. Nearly immediately thereafter, we are struck with a sudden need to revise our newly built gen ed. Is it the government threats? Is it that faculty who are advising into it find this a convenient time to manipulate process? We'll never know. Still, however one felt about the issue, it was an extremely burdensome workload and accompanying sense that if we don't do this NOW (yesterday!) everything will fall apart. Did that materialize? Absolutely not. But no apology, no repair for the damage done. July 1: I will cut 5 million dollars in extraneous "faculty costs." Another threat, another emergency. Make oneself rest over summer. Try not to worry about losing one's job. First day of classes: new round of program cuts and a timeline for following a process laid out in the contract, that involves faculty input. Timeline ends in May. So ok. It's bad, but at least we can breathe, follow the timeline, see what is decided by the end of spring term. Two weeks later: hello: here's a new "proposal" to retrench a bunch of positions. Faculty: you figure it out. Also, keep teaching. Oh, and don't forget to focus on retention! What?! Faculty morale is connected to retention? I'm aghast! It's a "duh moment" for me, says my fearless leader. Faculty are

exhausted! Faculty teaching in the spotless new Gen Ed in particular have borne the burden of the revision, the individual program and course changes, and now the threatened "deactivation" without any consideration or ability to have input on these changes or threats. I am quite sure the students feel it. We ALL feel it. We are tired, we are disrespected, and our resources are poor -- not just salary, but all around -- sense of inclusion, sense that our work and expertise are respected... etc.

- The past year has been extremely hard for me. Facing financial struggles is quite serious, we should all be concerned, but I feel personally threatened by the university. I don't trust the latest decisions will benefit the students or the growth of the university in the future. I am concerned for the future and this has had a huge impact on my mental health and joy in the work that I do everyday.
- I feel disrespected and sometimes bullied by other faculty members who are extremely vocal and do not share my views, or represent my perspective. I feel as though some faculty have "quietly quit" and are no longer doing their job effectively. Committee work has become extremely difficult to accomplish and the few are taking on the work of the many. I think that some faculty are suffering from mental health issues and bring that to the workplace. While I am very happy with my department (and school) colleagues and culture, I often feel as though there is a hostile work environment when dealing with faculty outside of my school, specifically in A&S, and specifically in Faculty Senate and committee work.
- the worst place I have ever worked
- Here's one detail: when [Name] was dean of A&S he asked me for a copy of my book for the office. It was just returned to me because "there's no space" for faculty publications. Hard to believe the office can't find a bookshelf to recognize faculty accomplishments. Hard to believe admin thinks so lowly of us that they can't show appreciation for us. I don't believe there's an administrator on campus who has shown any level of human concern for me in the past year.
- To put it bluntly, it sucks. Morale is low and continues to be low. My workload is unmanageable and it feels as though no matter how hard we try to explain to the administration our needs, we are pushed to do more with less. I am drowning and there is no end in sight. I am terrified for the fall at having less members of my department and being asked to take on the same workload or more. I will break and I will not be the only one in my department to do so. No one seems to recognize the amount of work being asked of us. Frankly I would look for another job, but given how much I have had to do over the last 5 years plus, I no longer feel I am a good candidate for the type of job I want. This certainly isn't the Utica I originally joined.
- A lot of folks who have been at the institution for a long period are scared that the place where they have lived and grown is going to close. I am concerned that while the administration has a plan, we have had many plans for the past 4 years, and none of them have been enough. We have lost a lot of good staff and faculty due to the same cycle of

try, fail, or miss the targeted goal and repeat. Note: This is a whole-campus issue, not one solely reliant on the administration.

- Hard to have good positive morale with the constant anxiety due to the lack of financial stability and job security. In half of the academic years since I have been hired faculty received some extent of pay cut or loss of contractual raises, COVID played a role in some of this. The pay changes but expectations and high standards for research and service do not. It is completely outlandish to ask someone to work the same for less money during a time when inflation is making it difficult to live comfortably supporting a family. Staff received a flex day, so they were not working the same for less money and faculty were just told to basically bend over backwards to save the university now TWICE in the last 4 years.
- morale is very low
- I seriously cannot believe we're going to have students pick classes based on a guess as to what can actually be offered.
- Keep calm and pray
- I dislike the AAUP leadership more than our administration.
- The current climate is anywhere from aggressively ambivalent to actively hostile. The lack of communication and transparency from senior leadership, coupled with devastating decisions, has made it quite hard to even show up on a daily basis. Everything that is being done is a screaming reminder of how little this place values me and my colleagues.
- There seems to be a great disconnect between what we hear from the administration vs. what we hear from the union. It's disconcerting, and I often don't know who to believe.
- Since 2020 every year has been worse than the one before. I arrive every day not wanting to work (except to see my students), because we're so busy with "unimportant busy work" like redoing Gen Ed over and over, or being part of task forces that go nowhere, that we never really get time to do creative things. We did visioning work in 2019, where faculty came up with creative ways to become better teachers/professionals, and then those suggestions were ignored/chucked, and all we got was a "Center for Faculty Excellence" that is nothing more than tech support. We should be excited to work with each other, but every time I try to do so either I get overburdened or my colleagues do, and nothing creative ever seems to happen. The best I can do is remodel my own courses bit by bit, and I almost never have support or conversation because setting those things up requires me to instigate it, and I'm just SO TIRED of trying to make things happen. Too much inertia around here. Too many silos. And it seems like the BoT/administration WANTS it that way to prevent us from, idk, having any power or freedom.
- It was awful under President Casamento and has improved very little since she left, because she left a mess!

- I really hope this solicitation of feedback does not become yet another case of faculty being asked to put in time and work on something that then is not followed with meaningful action. The culture of perma-crisis and lack of institutional structural support to navigate the traumas of the last few years has taken a real toll. To be clear, I think we need things like grief counseling to help people accept and heal. I think we need opportunities to connect with one another (faculty, staff, and administration alike) outside of formal meetings and form surveys.
- People are scared for their jobs. It is also interesting that some people in higher administration have been "moved" into positions to keep them "safe" without having to go through the application and interview process. This has been a big detriment to faculty morale and trust.
- Over the past few years, the salary reductions and limited institutional resources have significantly affected morale and professional development. Many faculty feel constrained in pursuing continuing education, research, and teaching innovation due to the lack of funding and institutional support. The uncertainty surrounding the university's long-term financial stability has also created anxiety among faculty and staff. Reduced salaries have made it increasingly difficult to recruit and retain qualified faculty, which may ultimately impact the quality of education and the university's reputation. More transparent communication about institutional decisions and plans for sustainability would help rebuild trust and confidence.
- The suspense that we have to wait until 12/17 to know who stays and who goes is devastating.
- Awful. Morale was already poor but since 7/1 - more to the point, with the prevailing lack of real and sincere communication from the leadership and the lack of transparency - morale has gone to a new low. For the majority of my career here, I truly loved coming to campus. Not anymore. I no longer take pride in this institution. I no longer feel like I am home here. I used to feel like I was part of a community that extended across schools. Not anymore. I also don't see how something like the earlier climate can be restored. This place is a sea of conflict and exploitation. All of this has takes a negative toll on me when I'm away from here. It's hard to shake off the effects of working at UU.
- Only a few speak at Senate and control the entire meeting and if you speak against them, you are belittled and essentially told to be quiet. The intimidation forces the majority to be silent.
- As a full-time, tenured faculty member in a strong school/department, I have a more than two decade perspective on the institution, and a more than 40 year relationship with Utica as an alum as well. Institutional knowledge is critical in any organization. Sadly, our executive team (not their fault), is lacking anyone who has a long history with the organization. Faculty with many years have only one perspective, a view from the faculty. Admin with a long history have only one view as well, from admin. The current administration cannot, and should not, be held responsible for the condition we're in. This

president and provost just got stuck "...holding the bag," so to speak; a bag filled with two decades of poor decisions from past administrations and Boards of Trustees. At the time, it was felt that decisions were appropriate. Hindsight is always 20/20. No one wants to "blame" any one president or board. Blame, however, and responsibility are two different things. The common denominator in all conversations has been the conversation around the demographic cliff, and how the "cliff" is the reason we are where we are. When the Western Interstate Commission for Higher Education (WICHE) published their critical report in 2008, *Knocking at the College Door: Projections of High School Graduates by State and Race/Ethnicity 1992 - 2022*, we knew what was to come here at Utica and how our climate would be impacted. Two presidents before the current president knew exactly what was in that report, and it was discussed widely by administrators and faculty members. The question was, however, what did we do about it at the time, and how did those decisions, or lack thereof, impact Utica today. Between 2010 - 2013, the plan was to have Utica as a University of 10,000+ students within five years of the planned launch of the School of Online & Extended Studies around 2012-2013/14. The plan included the lease of space on Rhoades Drive and eventually downtown, expansion into the Washington DC footprint, and Florida. Utica would have broken away from all Deltak/Wiley ties and done all of our own marketing, recruitment, processing, student support, and all other functions done by Deltak/Wiley. In the end, at the 23rd hour, the Board of Trustees declined to fund the final leg of the journey, and the project was dead. The ramp-up, however, was the beginning of our metaphorical end, and why we sit where we are today. Sadly, many of the barriers (although my faculty colleagues would never admit their shortcomings), were the direct result of their own doing (the 2008 bitter contract standoff that stalled cutting edge programs getting to market, like Cybersecurity, the failure of the faculty to adapt to the need for less residency programs and shorter programs; moving from 15 week delivery to 11, 10, and finally 8-week models, and so on). With no new meaningful alternative revenue in sight to "float" the albatross that is, and will always be, the traditional brick and mortar ground campus expenses, our future was now cast in stone. The robust online programs of the past that, for many years, floated the ground campus deficit, started to dry up, and thus the die was cast. There is no "money" in traditional undergraduate, ground-based, residential campus operations. The only way to support a ground-based only campus is to either 1.) have robust alternative/auxiliary revenue and/or 2.) drastically reduce personnel expenses and non-essential land/building/related expenses until projected expenses meet realistic revenue projections (where we find ourselves today). I provide this context/backstory, because it is accurate history that few left on the campus actually know, or would ever admit. Gone are the great (arguably) story tellers of our accurate history, [Name], [Name], [Name], [Name], [Name], [Name], and [Name]. I provide you with this backstory because it's a history that needs to be told, not for the first time, but as a reminder that this is what brought us to where we are today. Let's not blame, or look to blame any one person or

administration, or the "demographic cliff," or the pandemic, or the current or past federal or state administrations. None of this will make the loss of jobs/careers or salaries or our future any "easier." However, I believe that accurate history is the great equalizer. We are where we are because we put ourselves here. Our failure as an administration, a board, and a faculty, to acknowledge the clear headwinds that we were to face, and to take decisive and timely action to mitigate those headwinds. We have only ourselves to blame, if blame is what people seek. It is unfair, but a reality, that this administration has the horrible task of "holding the bag" from a history of poor decisions that can all be clearly traced back to specific times in our history where we failed to act decisively, creating a domino effect that leads to where we are today. This falls on all of us. For those of us who have watched from afar over the past two plus decades here at Utica, this should come as no surprise. The climate at Utica will change over time. Right now, all we can do is keep the heart and lungs pumping, and perfuse the rest of the metaphorical Utica body as best as we can.

- I feel like I'm on a sinking ship. There is no hopeful messaging coming from senior leadership, which tells me a lot about where we are going.
- The current climate is horrid; it is the culmination of serious morale deterioration happening for well over a decade - but accelerating dramatically over the past 5+ years. From a warm, caring community, we are now a cold, selfish everyone for themselves environment - created by statements, priorities, and actions by the administration. Especially demoralizing is the clear sense of favorites and non-favorites exhibited by the administration.
- Beyond faculty and a few administrators, Utica had become to feel more like working at a faceless corporation or a factory where we come in, do our jobs, earn a paycheck, and leave for a more enjoyable life. My sense of purpose as an academic has been eroded to the point that I rarely see myself as a professor.
- The uncertainty and lack of clarity is a breeding ground for fear, anxiety and poor morale. It is unfair to faculty, staff and students most especially. I have NEVER been in a more volatile work environment and yet I still try to stand strong for my students.
- I have seen the impact on morale since starting at the University. My main concerns are at the institution-level and include the lack of direct communication, immense workloads, and the lack of feeling valued by the institution.
- Faculty are never acknowledged for the level of attention and care that we give the students. The number of faculty who buy food and items for students because the administration either doesn't care or doesn't know (how they don't know our students need food and resources is beyond me) that students' needs are not being met. So faculty pick up the slack and make up for what the administration is not willing to do. But because of that, admin doesn't make efforts to actually help the students because they know they can take advantage of faculty because we ALWAYS show up for our students. In ways beyond the classroom. ACKNOWLEDGE THAT. I'm sick of being told by the



president to "go talk to students" - WE ARE talking to students. We do hear them and WE support them. It also makes it incredibly hard to do our jobs effectively when programs and software don't meet our needs. I have been told by IITS three times this semester that programs that previously worked with Google no longer work with Microsoft so the programs I was using for research or student support/scheduling are no longer viable and there are no options available to make up for those programs I can't use anymore. We can't be effective scholars on budget software. This is a retention issue. When students can't do research with their professors, they will go pay cheaper tuition at a school that DOES care about scholarship. This doesn't even include the Moodle issues this semester - the number of days programs and websites have been down or "slow" is too many. We cannot do our jobs if things don't work. If you want us to use Moodle and use what you provide for us, make sure it works. And when it doesn't, be willing to acknowledge it and offer change.

- The climate and culture are toxic at best. The administration's failure to address financial problems and lack of clear and honest communication has led to a vacuum of facts. Many faculty members feel like they are living in the Hunger Games, fighting to not be the one that gets cut.
- Morale is extremely low primarily because it feels like there is a lot of mystery and uncertainty about the future of the university.
- Quite frankly, it's awful and I don't think we can get any lower. In my opinion, it's been bad since 2020 when we were under-appreciated and undervalued for the extreme personal (not only financial) sacrifices we made during the pandemic that no other local institution went to the same measures that caused their faculty to literally cry late at night prepping for classes while fearing for their lives. Since then, morale has plummeted and I really don't think we can go any lower than we are now. There is no regard for what we do as faculty. We are not consulted with major changes that affect our job function (e.g. Microsoft transition, which has decreased my productivity and efficiency). We are not valued as or recognized as professionals and leaders in our fields/teaching as faculty and always lumped with staff with no acknowledgement of the load we carry for this institution and the sacrifices we make (financially and otherwise like teaching with limited to no resources at times). We are always blamed for the problems of the institution and this has been happening for years. Staff sacrifices and layoffs are thrown in our faces without real recognition of the sacrifices (financial and otherwise) we make affecting our personal and professional lives. I don't think senior leadership understands how deeply we are affected by these. Flex Time for staff was a major slap in the face for faculty coming off the pandemic. Staff were essentially rewarded while faculty continue to sacrifice in so many ways. Flex Time has also affected faculty productivity with delayed responses and actions by staff. I just can't understand why Flex Time continues to exist when this could be a cost saving measure to eliminate this program. It's clear that senior leadership has no insight into what faculty do considering their responses to how

we are supposed advise for the spring semester when classes will surely be canceled in great numbers. Their lack of forethought and lack of response scares me. I have no doubt that my advising workload will be doubled without senior leadership pre-planning the effects of these layoffs for the greater institution, faculty, and students. Their actions and lack of actions are severely affecting faculty morale. It is also trickling to students and will continue to in seen and unseen ways.

- The pay here sucks, especially when you're first hired. To tell people that have worked for almost nothing, for years, that their exorbitant salary/benefits are causing our downfall, when the real cause is horrifying, incompetent, perhaps even criminal mismanagement by the administration and the board, is jaw-dropping. In every communication to us, we are treated like morons and fed sound bites. The administration's job is to provide us with compensation, and we have, as yet, to my knowledge, received no apology for the abject, humiliating failure on the part of the administration to fulfill its obligation to us, even as we continue to do an amazing job with the students. Retention is down, and guess who got blamed, and charged with fixing it, even though it's not their fault? [spoiler alert: not the administration]
- There are groups popping up that are taking steps to connect people together, which is encouraging. I would like to see more of those opportunities to connect with one another; faculty, staff, administration, and students
- The faculty senate are toxic. They are angry and being forced to attend these meetings is disgusting. They are hateful and aggressive.
- It's toxic right now. No communication, finger pointing. Toxic.
- The climate at Utica declined starting with Laura assuming the presidency. At first, I felt optimistic because she worked very hard at transparency, so it was just initial niggles of concern that she seemed to have no idea what was going on in classrooms and with scholarship. But where morale absolutely tanked was in the summer of 2020 when it became clear that senior leadership was fine with mediocrity (Todd told us our hybrid and online courses simply had to pass "the sniff test" from NYSED while meanwhile I was trying to make my classes outstanding--this was insulting and out of touch). It also became clear during that time that leadership was unwilling to give faculty the resources to teach effectively during the pandemic, and at the same time completely unaware of the increased workload for faculty with some of the policies they were making. The workload was 3x's as much (each course was taught in person, online, and one-on-one when students got sick) and it had enormous ENORMOUS negative effects on faculty emotional, mental, and physical health. We layered burnout upon burnout during that time. It was honestly traumatic. All expressions of thanks afterwards lumped together staff (many of whom were safely at home with a lighter workload during the pandemic) and faculty (again, triple workload, facing student germs unvaccinated). In about a 5 year period (since spring 2020), we had many things imposed upon us. One of these was not caused or facilitated by senior leadership--the pandemic--and yet even in that case, senior



leadership exacerbated rather than alleviated the stressors related to the pandemic. Here's a list of the stressors (I might have forgotten one or two): pandemic teaching (this tripled my workload and I absolutely nailed it--a fantastic job--and this was not acknowledged or appreciated by anyone at the institution, unlike at other colleges and universities); two (!) givebacks in salary and benefits during a period of inflation, which caused super stressful financial difficulties to my family; a revision or two of Core/Gen Ed; the first portfolio review, which confusingly resulted in no layoffs; IITS changed all of our email/software from Google (superior) to Microsoft (highly inferior for basic email as well as teaching) without consulting faculty and with little warning, which is truly not normal for academic institutions. The general education revision and academic portfolio review created a lot of anxiety and bad interactions among faculty. The reverberations from that persist. I will never look at my colleagues the same way again. I get physically sick to my stomach at the thought of doing more general education discussions with my colleagues. I remember that faculty asked to put the gen ed and RPK reviews off until faculty had recovered from pandemic burnout--but we were told they were both urgent. Perhaps unsurprisingly, both of them (in my opinion) were poorly done and resulted in confusing outcomes. Before Laura, I felt appreciated for my excellence as a faculty member, and this in turn motivated me to continue doing my best work. I received handwritten notes from the president, provost, and dean applauding the good work I was doing. I still have them! I felt valued for my professional accomplishments, service, and teaching. Since Laura, and the "sniff test" era, I feel that I am actually penalized for striving for excellence--because it usually results in additional work and stress for me, much more than if I just went along with the tide of mediocre performance. I have to say that staff being at work on 4 days per week has also reduced the quality of the workplace for faculty. We spend a lot of time waiting to hear back from staff rather than helping our students quickly and efficiently. Which is another issue...unbelievable inefficiencies have persisted at Utica for years, and nothing changes. In recent years, I've gotten the sense that leadership perceives us to be a "degree mill" rather than reputable and excellent institution--and this is embarrassing to me. This series of leadership policies and approaches have led to me now, in 2025, wearing a mask--not a literal mask, but a figurative one. I have had that mask on since Fall 2020. The mask is upbeat, positive, and professional, while inside I feel demoralized, hopeless, and embarrassed about the quality of my workplace. Most days, when I arrive at work, I sit in my car reluctant to go inside and don my (figurative) mask. And no, I'm not depressed, all of these feelings are related to the low morale, support, resources, appreciation, and respect that I feel in my workplace--outside of work, things are fine! It's not too strong to say that this has been one of the hardest 5 years of my life, and almost all of that is due to workplace issues. I am extremely thankful for this opportunity to express some of the reasons for my low morale--I appreciate the fact that this survey exists. Thank you.

- I feel that I could not take on any more responsibility. If faculty from my department are retrenched, I don't know if I could take on any more responsibility. I sacrifice a lot of my personal time and my family's time for my job. I am not going to sacrifice any more! I also do not want to sacrifice best teaching practices by teaching too many students in a course to save money; this will continue to reduce moral ( in my opnion).
- Worst I've ever seen. The morale question is difficult to answer, since some--such as salary--have long been a problem, while others date to the last 2-3 years.
- There are other ways to save money without gutting staff and faculty. It takes \*people\* to make the university function. It takes \*people\* to do the work and build the relationships that retain students. Stop lying. Stop hiding financial information.
- It is very scary to try to guess who is next on the chopping block. Administration is heartless
- The decline in morale has existed since Casamento was named president. Anyone with a sense of awareness knew she was going to lead this institution to disaster. She proved those fears to be correct. The current administration took over a sinking ship and instead of helping faculty bail the water, decided to instead put more holes into the ship by continuing to undermine any hope to work across parties.
- I feel like all that matters is getting work done. No real communication, no collaboration, no support, no help with technology issues, just an overall get the job done no matter what and meet the students needs over your own at every moment of every day - without adequate staffing or resources.
- We do a very poor job of meaningful recognition of employees who deserve recognition.
- When I started here over a decade ago it felt like a family. I was excited to have my kids come here and I was proud to work here. Now it is a ghost town. There is no belonging. No sense of community. My kids don't visit. There are no events. Nothing to see or do.
- Lowest I have ever experienced
- Faculty have systematically been marginalized for years. The institution used to be a vibrant community of folks sharing their ideas (Faculty Forums; Retreats; etc.). Now everybody is silo-ed and the administration doesn't care about faculty and or their potential valuable feedback. And look what has become of the institution? When you don't value faculty and ethical decision-making, it is a death knell to higher education.
- I have been at Utica just 8 years. In that time, we experienced a low DOE that recovered from under Laura, dome failure, Covid, program failures in Florida, and now low enrollment (to name a few). It seems we have always had super huge challenges, some of them self-inflicted by leadership (already mentioned Florida) and some by faculty (e.g., overly complicated and restrictive GenEd that does not attract or retain students, a Faculty Senate that requires 100% of FT faculty to attend but only enables the most outspoken voices in the room). Utica is swimming in macro-level challenges in demographics and higher ed. It has been hard to work at Utica for some time, given the

uncertainties and challenges, but hopefully we can turn a corner and make Utica U a sustainable organization for our students, our community, and our university colleagues (faculty and staff alike). Some faculty feel that they were lied to in December and January when the give-back was signed. Their perception is real, but wrong given the unprecedented melt and low retention that occurred in the summer of 2025. Regarding "The institution encourages you to have a voice and express concerns openly." The institution is fine, my faculty peers make this challenging: the proof is that the same people speak in Faculty Senate or Union Meetings. Some might feel they are faculty leaders, and that may be true, but often it showcases others' concern if they spoke up. Regarding Question 10: Todd is doing a good job, but his communication is what seems to make the issue more difficult. Regarding Question 11: Stephanie is managing the situation very well.

- Many people seem to be discouraged
- Although we are in a very challenging situation as an institution, many others are feeling similar challenges. From my personal experience, the president and the provost here at Utica are doing a better job than I have witnessed during my time at other institutions who faced similar circumstances.
- The campus feels empty. People sometimes get defensive when discussing important matters. Seniority creates a barrier to open communication.
- Being continuously misled by the past and current administration about the financial health of the university, and therefore the stability of my employment, has been a huge source of anxiety for me the whole time I've worked here. On top of that, my mind goes to President Pfannestiel's comments at a spring 2025 meeting that anyone who thinks Utica is closing 'should just leave'. That comment spat in the face of faculty like me who have literally been sick with worry wondering about the state of the school, the way I provide for myself and my family. It also disregards the role the current and previous administrations have played in the creation of a climate so filled with uncertainty and fear. There has been extremely little compassion for how being kept in this state of anxiety for YEARS negatively impacts the mental and physical health of Utica University employees, and therefore our ability to do our jobs.
- Many times we have asked for help to help our students during multiple crisis points. We received no help or even feedback.
- I find it hard to believe that disgruntled faculty can turn their feelings on and off when it comes to teaching in their discipline. In short, the students can tell that many of the members of the faculty are disgruntled. Furthermore, that has also jeopardized faculty to faculty professional relationships.
- This is a toxic workplace. As a faculty member, I say this specifically referring to other faculty and, especially, administrators. Administration is gleeful when faculty treat each other badly. So it is an isolating, lonely place to work. I can't count the number of days I

come in and no one speaks to me, let me alone speaks a kind word. It's sad and I hope that it changes, I wish that someone would treat me with some respect.

- A lot of decisions that are being made at the institutional level right now feel illogical or nonsensical (like retrenching faculty while the existence of their programs is still up for negotiation, insisting that "having faculty in the right places" is not equivalent to programmatic retrenchment, etc.). When things don't make sense, especially to us highly-invested-in-logic types, it creates an atmosphere of fear and uncertainty; a sensation that anything could happen, and it'll probably be bad. That's a serious blow to morale, and it'll take some time to recover from. That recovery can only begin when decision-making begins to take a logical, ordered path through predictable steps, and even then, it will take time to rebuild the faculty's faith that leadership will consistently make those kinds of decisions and not devolve back into chaos.
- I believe we all need to get behind the leadership to make meaningful and lasting changes that will preserve the long-term financial well-being of Utica University.
- I have never seen the general morale as low as it is now. We survived a shooter-on-campus scare, COVID, the switch to online instruction with no preparation, and now salary give-backs and loss of retirement contributions---I fear we will not survive the current crisis.
- feel that there are unrealistic expectations for coordinators, program directors, etc. This filters down to other staff and faculty. If this level of leadership cannot handle the workload - then how can others?
- Deflating not knowing if you have a job next semester and if the institutional remain open.
- I am more concerned about the way senior faculty treat the administration and other faculty than the other way around. I once defended an administrator's point of view and promptly received an email from a senior faculty member denigrating me---not refuting my arguments only calling me names.

**Please list 3 ways the institution's leadership team might improve morale at Utica University.**

- #1 - For quite a while now, when we've been asked to express our concerns & offer input, it seems that all that information goes into a void. There are plenty of examples in the last 10 years where a committee or task force has been convened and done months of work only to have the administration essentially, say "thanks, but we're going a different route". First year seminar and GenEd are two that come to mind. That's demoralizing. #2 - I think there should be a true evaluation / improvement process for everyone on campus, including the administration. As far as I know, my direct supervisor has never been evaluated. None of the long term employees in the department have ever been asked to provide input. This person's leadership appears to be minimal at best, but is mostly non-

existent. We succeed at what we do in spite of them. That's demoralizing. #3 - If we have a hope at all of making this institution a destination for students, then we have to change the culture and messaging on campus. Attracting, retaining, and working with great students is a joy that should be baked into our daily mission. More importantly, if we can find a way to help those students understand and articulate the foundation that they are creating for themselves here at Utica U then we're doing our jobs correctly. #4 - If there's going to be a publicly discussed scrutiny of the academic programs, then there should be an equally intensive review of the other areas of campus. And EVERYONE, should have a voice. These should not be siloed programs. They should be symbiotic.

- This would mostly come from better communication in all directions. Faculty need to know the student intake process. They also need to be copied on global student emails. Simple periodic meetings with the president or provost on a school level to check in on how things are, what changes would be useful, what we're seeing with the students, and to get honest feedback on what is and isn't possible; to actually be heard and seen.
- Maybe opportunities for faculty to socialize (coffee groups)? I feel like the Unity walk can be unifying - perhaps an event to inspire? At one institution I worked, our department required a mediator to help us work through some issues - are there some programs that could benefit from that sort of thing?
- 1. Educate the Board about how their past presidential assessment ensures that they will receive misinformation from the president. They need to enact comprehensive assessment of senior leadership that allows affected constituencies to provide evidence of problems that would be invisible to the Board but that can balloon into serious problems, like we are facing now, if not resolved in the early stages. We are not a factory, construction company, or fast food restaurant. We need a different management system...top-down management is outdated and ineffective. The toxic relationship with the board is the most serious problem that MUST be overcome. 2. Help those faculty who still care to work to create an environment of excellence in all areas of faculty work. We do well in service and teaching but scholarship is a trainwreck. Faculty with no real peer-reviewed publications in decades are being rewarded with Clark Research Chair and Clark research awards and promotion to Full and Distinguished Professor. That is demoralizing. How are we expected to retain high quality early career faculty when they see the capricious nature of tenure, promotion, and award-making. 4. Provide venues that enhance collegiality within and among groups. 5. I didn't feel that this survey did a good job of probing my concerns so I think targeted surveys to different groups based on responses from this survey could identify the most serious issues for each group. Don't let this be where this process ends.
- The obvious....faculty efforts should be in providing our students the an excellent education, not in worrying about the future of the institution. Perhaps admitting how we got into the mess we currently find ourselves in. Admitting what mistakes were made would be appreciated. There is blame that needs to be admitted to.

- Almost an impossible situation, again. Make efforts, and the naysayers will just complain that you're not being genuine or are trying to pacify them. Spend money, and we add to the problem. What can you do? Be like a parent. Treat the kids with respect, empathy, celebrate their wins, listen to their fears, listen to them complain, but keep the boundaries solid. Be the role model you want all your kids to be like. I never expected my parents to share everything that was required to keep the household going, nor do I do that with my kids. I sure don't expect the leaders of a business to do the same...as long as they have the interests of the family unit in mind, we have to respect what they're doing too.
- Be honest; Be transparent
- Communicate more often. Communicate clearly. Genuinely try to work WITH the union leadership. ASK department/program chairs about the ramifications of "cuts" BEFORE enacting a plan to carry them out. Hopefully the retrenchment process will be behind us soon, but the ramifications of this and what will happen to the program that survive is frightening.
- I believe that it is too late for the current leadership team to improve morale because they have expressed disdain and a lack of human warmth and care for so long that to suddenly change course would be seen as disingenuous. One area that has consistently poor is Communications & Marketing, having been understaffed and poorly resourced for decades. There is little effort (and even less interest) in sharing what we do with the outside world except for athletics and feeble attempts at admissions advertising. The community has completely lost its sense of attachment to the institution, which is now widely seen as separate and apart from the community.
- I believe we need honest, effective and empathetic leadership that promotes trust, stability, and rebuilds our community. 1) Much greater transparency by the President in sharing the details of our financial situation 2) More candor and transparency in real time by the President and Provost in exercising leadership, and more and deeper genuine opportunities for stakeholders to shape the direction and operating values of the institution 3-A concentrated effort to rebuild trust and goodwill between top leaders and students/faculty/staff
- Transparency, standard policies that are followed, greater respect.
- 1. Resign 2. Apologize Publicly 3. See Answers 1 & 2
- Listen to what we are already telling you in meetings. Stop blaming faculty for the mistakes made by administrators. Own the financial problems. Own also your personnel decisions. How did "we" grow programs out of control, when it's the administration who has to approve every new program, every new hire or TT line. If we couldn't afford to grow like this, we shouldn't have hired and promoted and tenured 31 "extra" people. That's not faculty's fault. That is the fault of poor leadership. So, what to do? Cut unnecessary costs. Cut the pay for the top-paid people. They'll still eat. They'll still be able to have their kids' college tuition forgiven. They'll still make ends meet on needs,



even if they have to slim down on extras. Rather than then let people go in the middle of an academic year, no? I mean, when the schedule has already gone live for spring?

Couldn't the provost and other senior admin go to half pay or even less, to save 1-5 jobs and families? What else are you considering? ESF has a published early retirement plan with a small lump-sum payment. Have you considered it? I guess that's 3.

- I would especially like the university to think of other possibilities instead of retrenchment. Our community and the people that are a part of it is what keep many of us dedicated to our work. This environment of threat is one of the things that has made Utica a very toxic working place lately.
- 1. BE ACCOUNTABLE! If you ask a committee to do work and provide recommendations or report out - read the report, follow up on recommendations, don't make us think we are completely wasting our time. 2. Learn to effectively communicate. There should be an updated org chart at all times of who to contact in which departments for what purposes. The frequent comings and goings being reported in Morning Mention are not sufficient. I don't even know who works in which departments anymore. Sending a global email during a high traffic email time (i.e. first week of school), is not sufficient. During a time of crisis (currently), we should be getting frequent updates from senior leadership - weekly or biweekly emails with what's going on, updates since last message, etc.
- all new leadership mentoring program
- More transparent and timely communication Apply compassion and empathy in decision making Consider how impacts of decisions will affect student experiences
- To be frank, I feel the policy of promoting from within, particularly in regard to leadership positions, is one of the reasons a toxic working environment and rotten culture has festered for so long. I think Utica needs new leadership from outside if there is to be a chance of fixing this.
- 1. Mentorship and Onboarding for a period of time - at a minimum one semester to two to get a full appreciation of the workload and how to manage. Lessened workload for the first semester to ensure onboarding and success, lack of overload, overwhelmed, and unsure how to do the job you are hired for. A clear expectation of work (description and documentation of each onboarding step). Observation of courses, clinicals, labs, and simulations, etc. 2. Financial incentive; Yearly / Annual Raises based on performance and student/peer/leader evaluations 3. Fair equity of workload across All Faculty, Staff, and Leadership. I am working until 11pm most nights to ensure I learn the materials, update the materials, grade student work, assess their learning needs, update activities, exams and quizzes to courses
- Talk to us outside of meetings and with respect. Speak to us truthfully (especially the provost). Answers emails (president and dean of humanities)



- Come walk a mile in our shoes. Come see what we do on a day to day basis to teach lectures and organize lab, then tell us to do more with less. Recognize what we mean to this institution and that we are hurting.
- #1 Employment issues - Take action on the staff and faculty who are constantly complained about at the lower level, including administrators. While a few VP or dean-level staff members who were underperforming have left, others remain the topic of daily conversation among employees on campus. A short walk around campus from someone with limited ties to the administration would quickly identify those who should be put on a work improvement plan and then let go without improvement. Far too many consistently empty seats or individuals in roles they are unable to properly fill, while others are stretched thin doing multiple jobs to cover for supervisors or coworkers who are underperforming. Empty offices, closed doors, and unavailable staff and faculty all lead to lower retention and morale. #2 Faculty and Staff Division - Try to do more events that mix staff and faculty together. Far too many staff don't know the faculty and vice versa. While this shouldn't be the administration's responsibility to change, it is a major issue that has caused a divide. #3 Veteran employees - Do something special for those who have been through this before and helped us get to where we are today, and will help us get to where we need to be tomorrow. The list of employees with 10 years or longer of service appears to be shrinking each year. Flex time was available to everyone equally, rather than being based on seniority or some process that made it a reward for good work and service, rather than just an ordinary perk offered to everyone.
- Stop asking for equal or more work for less money. Stop having the same expectations for scholarship and service for less and with less support. Faculty are expected to publish, but the University does pay for APC!!!! (Not even close to the full amount anyways.) Transparency.
- Collaborate with faculty for solutions instead of making grand gestures of authority and expecting submission. Interact with us more and SHOW you care. Come to see the things we do and take time to share appreciation of those things. Realize that downsizing to success isn't really a thing that works.
- 1. Continue to update and be available to answer questions 2. Focus on the positive - all the good the university has done and is still doing 3. Live from the inside -out. Stay consistent no matter the situation or circumstances
- Get rid of the AAUP. I realize you can't, so we're stuck with them.
- Stop running this place into the ground. Stop firing people because you are running this place into the ground. Stop trying to make people do multiple jobs because we keep firing and not replacing people.
- 1. Pay raises. 2. Better benefits (my HSA covers only a portion of what I have to pay out of pocket for a family of four). 3. Hire support staff when needed.

- As [Name] said, it's absolutely absurd to ask the ones who are hurt to ask how to stop being hurt, but I'll take some time from my overburdened day to try to answer this: 1. The leadership team should take a permanent 25% pay cut, and that money should be used to support student success so that we (faculty) are not spending so much time trying so hard to connect our students to support when they are struggling at college. 2. Faculty should be incentivized to visit each other's classes, and to provide FORMATIVE, CURIOUS conversation rather than to appear in those classrooms merely in an evaluative position. Related: provide stipends for faculty learning groups -- for example, weekly lunches and a small financial stipend for groups of say 4 faculty members from different schools to share time together to visit each others' classes for a semester and discuss what teaching/learning looks like in their disciplines. 3. Providing better end-of-semester surveys to students that both highlight students' progress through the courses and also do more than provide a "customer satisfaction survey" -- nothing is worse to morale than to teach 20 students, and for 19 of them to ignore the survey because everything is fine and for 1 to excoriate the teacher because they had a bad day or a bad experience that the teacher never even knew about -- and then for colleagues to judge the faculty member based on that one review, which usually says absolutely nothing about what was learned or the student's growth. To continue to use the SOOTs is absolutely detrimental to our well-being. Period.
- 1. Acknowledge their role in the decline in both the financial health and morale of the university and its faculty and staff 2. Stop pretending that decline in enrollment due to the demographic cliff is the villain in our current scenario. 3. Acknowledge your mistakes
- 1. Actual transparency around decisions and budgeting. 2. Stop depicting faculty as the cause of budget deficits. Millions of dollars have been spent on external vendors and real estate and no one has ever taken responsibility for those losses. To blame faculty for deficits or to blame staff for not keeping student morale higher is not just disingenuous, it's mean. 3. Grief counseling, mental health support, or support from restorative justice mediators. We need outside help to improve broken lines of communication and to start rebuilding trust.
- 1. STOP BEING SELFISH AND SELF-CENTERED: TAKE A PAY CUT TO SAVE JOBS!!!! 2. Hire a marketing team and bring in new programs to increase enrollment!!! No one wants to hear that we have "chosen" to be the university that has "decided" to be small and insignificant. 3. Stop lying, stop replacing Dean positions with upper admin to keep them from retrenchment, and hire an upper admin that gives a damn about how their actions and decisions affect the faculty and students.
- 1- Restore competitive salaries and benefits to help attract and retain qualified faculty and staff. 2- Invest in professional development and teaching resources, ensuring faculty have the tools and support to deliver high-quality education. 3- Increase transparency and shared governance, with regular communication from leadership about financial status, decision-making processes, and long-term strategic plans.

- Not sure there is something that can be done given the current climate.
- 1) More transparency 2) Treat individuals as individuals, not a group. 3) Offer support and listen to employees.
- One way: Find a way to decrease our teaching load. Students need more support in all ways now than they did even 5 years ago and AI has changed everything. Pedagogy must change, and it is a lot of work to retool, on top of everything else. (And I am doing that work but I am exhausted.) We have always had a heavy workload. Now, it is crushing. I rarely have a satisfying day of work. I've been worn down and down and down. I love teaching and developing new approaches and techniques. But, Admin, you have burned me out. It is difficult to do the very thing that I love under the working conditions at UU.
- open communication better faculty and staff support better control in Senate to allow other than the typical 4 who commandeer the meeting every month with their rhetoric which in many instances is not even related to the topic. No one cares how long they have been here and has nothing to do with the topics in most instances. Many talk to hear themselves talk and extends meetings for no reason.
- 1.) The old adage, "...the definition of insanity is doing the same thing...with the same people...and expecting a different result" is where we are. If we keep asking the same people in places of leadership to impact retention and student success to keep impacting student-success & retention, and retention continues to waffle, at best, it's time to change people in positions of leadership who are responsible for retention and student success. Yes, it's multi-faceted and no one person's fault. However, someone needs to "own" and be "responsible" and "accountable" for retention. If they're not producing, and we going back to the same people...time to change the people. If the next Team doesn't work...change them again until you find the rock star who can truly impact retention, following the old adage, "...it's far easier and cheaper to retain a student, than it is to recruit one." 2.) Find a [Name] in the Faculty (and staff) who can tell the story of our history over the past 20 years. Find the Dumbledore (spelling) who commands respect and Team them with an admin counterpart to tell the story in a video series, for example. Again, it won't help those who are going, but it may instill a sense of ownership for those who remain. And...it just may "soften" a difficult blow. A fireside chat series, perhaps, or video series "Beyond the Morning Mention," or something along those lines. Hand over the vision to [Name] in Marketing & Communications and let him run with it. I'm going to bet that will boost faculty and staff morale to hear stories from their own. 3.) Engage our Psychology and related faculty and Health folks (faculty and staff) to collectively set up an immediate Care Response Support Team (counseling, HR, spiritual/faith leaders); a group who will work to do nothing else but to confidentially work directly with those immediately impacted by these changes over the next year or so. People who receive death notifications from traumatic events/news will always tell you that they may never remember the words you used (legal documents, statements, perfunctory duties), but, they will always remember how you made them feel in the moment. For many, what is

going on now, and perhaps in the future, is like a death notification for many. An organization is an inanimate object that can never love you back, no matter how much one may love the organization. This Care Response Support Team should be immediately formed and engaged to help those whose lives are about to change. Seeing these steps will improve morale by folks seeing the highlighting of the humanity in an otherwise traumatic process.

- If you can't pay us more, then give us more paid time off.
- Stop eliminating raises, staff, and programs and stop implementing retirement contribution freezes and salary give-backs to make up for faulty decisions made at the higher levels. Recognize you have highly qualified, quality, dedicated staff and faculty and see and treat them with genuine respect. Consult with faculty before making significant decisions - as used to routinely be done years ago - because more eyes and brains may see and prevent problematic decisions like several made in recent years. Recognize what retains students is a warm, caring environment in which EVERYONE feels welcome, safe, and respected - including, very importantly, the staff and faculty as well as the students. Staff and faculty do not currently feel - and ARE not - welcome, safe, and respected. Because of this, students can feel it. There is a sad, cold, scary mood permeating the entire campus that no doubt has and will continue to negatively impact retention and thus recruitment of students.
- 1. Faculty have very little role in the decisions made by this institution, we need a seat at the table. 2. Re-establish the sense of community that once existed here. 3. Be forthright in communications to faculty and staff.
- Offer clarity, transparency and compassion - through leadership that is strong, honest and empathetic of others
- Clear, direct, and honest communication - even when it is not desirable news.
- 1.) Remove the current president 2.) Communicate on time -- the majority of campus never got emails about the power being out; that is a FAILURE!! send emails!! Give us information! If I was a parent of a college-age kid, I'd pull my kid out of this school so fast because that was an obvious failure from the Provost and I wouldn't be able to trust the school would communicate for more serious emergencies. As a faculty member, I have zero trust that we will be notified if something more serious were to occur on campus. 3.) Acknowledge the workload that faculty have taken on. Both the required stuff and everything else. We actually do care about students. Tell us you see that rather than making it seem like faculty are the problems and that only faculty can fix retention issues. That is not going to happen. Administration needs to acknowledge resources are the problem, NOT the faculty.
- Stop attending every faculty senate meeting and muddying the waters. Stop over communicating with dozens of emails. Actually follow good leadership principles, make a statement, don't repeat yourself, don't explain yourself. Then when you see someone in passing, talk to them, ask if they have concerns or how things are going.

- 1. Take responsibility. You took the big titles and big paychecks. You are responsible for the mess the University is in. Stop blaming others. It is not the faculty, trustees, union, the economy or Donald Trump. You failed to identify the changing market we operate in or were unwilling to act in time to adjust to it. 2. Step up or step down. You are leading from behind and waiting for others to force decisions. This happened with the DEI mandates and retrenchment. If this University is to be saved it has to be done by decisive leadership. 3. Communicate clearly, fully and honestly. The lack of facts is creating chaos. You found a way to write a full-page email about power outages, but haven't clearly communicated a word about the upcoming layoffs that will affect dozens of employees.
- Be much more transparent so we have a better understanding about what is really happening at the university behind the scenes, especially regarding the financial situation.
- Improve communication, be honest with faculty and staff, and collaborate with them to resolve problems.
- 1-Don't cut our salary and benefits again. Period. Find other ways to save money. Re-evaluate staff and VP lines that could be laid off. You are already gutting our academic programs and faculty layoffs in great numbers. Do you really think we can take more personal sacrifices? We are supporting families. We are trying to make ends meet. 2-COMMUNICATE WITH US. I've lost track of the number of VPs and other high-ranking admins/staff who have left the college and we received NO notification! These were forward facing people and we were never notified they left or who their replacements were. It makes the leadership seem like they are hiding things and don't care about the effects of these positions leaving the university on our ability to do our jobs. We were also never notified about the "state of the university" address at homecoming when important announcements were made about marketing changes. How can you give a "state of the university" without notifying the campus community about it? Again, what are you hiding? So much secrecy it seems because of lack of communication. 3-Treat us like professionals who actually have valuable ideas and input. I feel nothing more than a spec of dirt brushed under a rug. Value us. Promote the outstanding work we do in the classroom and research for marketing to show families why they should send their child here. UU is MORE than athletics and bouncy houses but that's all we seem to market. You can get two benefits out of one here...promote your faculty to show us you value us while showing prospective students why they should come here. Right now, it seems like we are a glorified rec program with the marketing we do (all sports and activities, no academics).
- (1) Do their f\*\*\*ing job, which is to provide the resources we need (including compensation, LMS's that work consistently, classrooms with non-distracting climate control, etc. etc. etc. etc.) (2) Stop treating us like a\*\*holes. Be honest with us, and care what we think. I don't mean "ask what we think then ignore us completely", I mean actually realize that we have important input. Noone has ever asked me why retention is

low. Never. I work with students, they don't. But they don't ask me. (3) Fire administrators who need firing. I won't name names here although I really want to, but you know who the f\*\*\* I'm talking about. A VP was fired over the summer - finally - and NOBODY KNEW. You want to reduce salary on campus? Try firing people who deserve it, not people who are busting their ass every day and doing a great job.

- Honestly, at this point I don't think there is anything that the administration could do that would improve morale. Part of it is the situation and part of it is people not taking ownership of their own morale. But, there are some things I would like to see that I think might help in the future and would also contribute to student retention would be to bring back things like squirrel day. It doesn't need to spend money with petting zoos but just cancel classes for a day, bring everyone together to play yard games and find new traditions like international pillow fight day in April. I also would like to see the benefit of our beautiful facilities accessible to us and our families. I was told when I was hired that we could use the gym and, at the time the pool, the fields, whatever wasn't in use by a sports team for me and my family. That would encourage us to gather for pick up games or work out together with students, our families, and us. It builds community. The last way I would like to see in the future are just small fun things like a hidden moose hunt (like hidden Mickey's at Disney) or reverse trick or treating where administration walks around handing out candy during classes on Halloween or a celebrity stuffed animal that mysteriously visits random offices and gets its picture taken for the morning mention. We need joy!
- Remove the faculty that make threats to quit, call leadership names at faculty senate and cannot see the big picture. Utica has to be a business as well as an education institution. The faculty that do not see that need to move on.
- - communicate with the faculty. We're professionals, treat us like such. - transparency. It seems like everything is behind closed doors or without any faculty input. - acknowledge. Stop blaming the faculty for the mess the ADMINISTRATION got us in to. We didn't make these deals, you did. Own it.
- 1--take constructive and effective actions to change the trajectory of the institution away from degree mill and towards excellence. This probably includes laying off faculty and staff who are not needed (in the case of faculty, because they have no advisees/program, required courses) or who are underperforming. As difficult as this would be, it would actually help me to believe that we are going to try something new and effective rather than whatever we've been doing for the last 5 years. This definitely includes recognizing true excellence when faculty display it (not false praise for stuff that everyone is already doing; or stuff that is actually embarrassingly substandard). This could include things like quick emails to say congratulations or making sure PR highlights faculty awesomeness WAY more often than they do. Also set higher standards for promotion, tenure, and PDC review. Our best faculty will respond to this appreciation and culture of excellence by raising the bar even higher--it's a win-win for all. Alternatively, if our identity actually IS



a degree mill, then be honest about that so faculty can understand the game plan and make professional decisions accordingly. 2--If you promise me a salary and benefits, don't change it. Pay me what you promised and what you owe me. This is part of our professional contract together. Certainly avoid insulting me even more by removing a good portion of my salary and benefits with very little notice. If you do cut my salary and benefits, my workload should also decrease (which was recognized for staff with flextime, but was not recognized for faculty during either of the givebacks). 3--stop lumping together faculty and staff. We play different roles at the institution. Don't say things like "I appreciate faculty and staff for stepping up" --probably one group did more and one did less for any given event and we deserve unique levels of gratitude. For example, when it comes to orientation--thank staff first and foremost and faculty for their support roles. For many other things, thank faculty first and foremost, remembering that without faculty, we have no institution at all--and that many faculty positions are not easily replaced with another person, due to the expertise and years of training required to become a faculty member. I feel so much gratitude for those on the staff who are competent and effective at assisting--they're incredible and they deserve to be thanked for the things they bring to the institution rather than being lumped with faculty. The same applies to faculty. Generalized thanks comes across as insincere and out of touch. 4--bonus answer! NO MORE GEN ED DISCUSSIONS please (I don't think this one will be possible though)

- 1) Demonstrate a genuine interest in the well-being of employees. We are not simply workers to complete another's bidding. Many of us dedicate a tremendous amount of time and energy to this place without any compensation or recognition. 2) Get out of their office(s) and actually see people. Say hello to people. Be around the institution. This can be as simple as dedicating 1 hour a week to doing so, and choosing different spaces to do this in each week. 3) Be honest. That's it. Don't lie.
- Release financial details sooner and provide more details. The admin has been playing games for a long time. I finally realized that it was done to keep the info from getting into the press. Not knowing exsarasabates feelings of uncertainty. Inform the faculty about the financial benchmarks, when they will be evaluated, and the contingency plans in place if the benchmarks aren't met.
- Be open, honest, and transparent. Yes, we need to save money, but I cannot sacrifice myself or my values as an educator to do so. Give us the time and the tools to provide a good education to our students, while allowing faculty the time to participate in research and service. I feel we are going to lose this.
- (1) Learn what we actually do. Retrenchment and portfolio review meetings have revealed that the leadership knows very little about what departments/programs/offices and individual faculty/staff members actually do for the institution. Leadership has regularly expressed surprise at what we accomplish. (2) Do not use students as a weapon against employees. Asking students to report when an employee expresses concern about



their job or their workplace is disgusting. The leadership should apologize publicly for this move. (3) Don't target women and faculty of color with these retrenchments and portfolio reviews.

- Tell us the truth. Answer questions.
- The President and Provost should take salaries equal to the lowest paid full-time employees. If your employees can make it work, so can you and it will save the university hundreds of thousands of dollars. Follow some of the advice you receive from staff and faculty and credit them when you do so. We've had enough lip service. Stop asking overburdened employees to do extra labor. Changing to Microsoft was extra labor. Changing to Moodle was extra labor. The meetings about retrenchment and program cuts are extra labor. Understaffed offices make more work for remaining staff. The administration keeps choosing to do things that create more labor and then acting like those changes are acts of god or as uncontrollable as the weather. Take some responsibility for your crappy decisions. Pretending you must do what you have \*chosen\* to do is downright rude. We aren't stupid.
- Telling us who they are firing, showing some compassion instead of an email stating that you are no longer needed, and being transparent
- Better communication about the plan and future of Utica University. I understand there is a union but the waiting game is very difficult
- 1) Actually start being honest (That is clearly hard to do). The President's "circle" of acquaintances, business contacts, etc. is much smaller than he realizes. Some of us know these same people for longer than Todd has been around. They talk too and I've gotten more insight into the dealings going on at UU from them than I have from our own administration. 2. Start listening to and working with faculty across ALL disciplines, not just "the golden 3" (they tried to say 20 but you're not fooling anyone). Time and again the faculty of those 3 schools have PROVEN they do not have the interests of the institution at heart. They are only concerned with their own self-preservation and seem to refuse to realize if they get rid of the rest of us, they're doomed. 3. Restore trust... and if leadership will refuse to do that, resign.
- New leadership Honesty Transparency
- More faculty and staff Workload that is just and equitable Increased wages to meet what others in the academic setting are making
- Provide more ways to publicly recognize/acknowledge employee accomplishments; provide hand-written notes to personally acknowledge people who do good things; bring back the beer at faculty forum :)
- Bring us together. Build community. Have events.
- Involve the staff and faculty more in decisions. Feels like no matter what we do we have no control over decisions

- 1. re-establish faculty forum 2. Schedule a few social events for faculty 3. Create a budget for light eats at department and/or school meetings. We lost something when everything went to zero. It would not be hard to get a "sponsor" to pay for each meeting.
- being transparent and honest answering questions when they arise in a timely manner
- Care about faculty input (other than simple lip-service). Value faculty work. Seek input from faculty. Stop referring to faculty as "staff". But if these "ideas" need to be written/spoken, then it's difficult to think that, magically, administration is going to start sincerely caring. TEACH Board of Trustee members that FACULTY are the foundation of the institution... not the transient administrators who come in and have ways to bolster THEIR resumes while putting the institution at financial and reputational risk.
- Get more students enrolled . . . that will improve morale!!!! Provide clarity on who the faculty that will be retrenched; the lack of clarity is the real issue. I faced layoffs at a previous organization, and knowing that I was either spared or targeted enabled me to start the process of coping. Limbo is worse than not knowing. Give each faculty member a puppy :) I disagree with [Name] . . . I would rather the leadership focus on building a sustainable Utica U rather than spending valuable time trying to throw a "morale-building" pizza party.
- Be totally open and transparent in all actions and communications. Please do not hide behind the lawyers Don't sidestep questions
- In my classroom, my students are my responsibility and therefore I feel it is up to me to bring a positive attitude to my workplace and create a caring and safe classroom culture.
- The lack of in-person participation in meetings may contribute to a diminished sense of community, which can lead to lowered morale. It might be necessary to set some limits on the frequency of remote meeting attendance. Additionally, spending more time with both students and colleagues face-to-face, along with incorporating in-person faculty retreats, would help boost morale.
- SHOW SOME COMPASSION. It feels awful to work somewhere that has felt contentious and unstable since I was hired, being pulled back and forth between thinking a solution has been found only for more bad news to come right behind it, and then see from their actions the administration doesn't seem to know or care how much that impacts us. TAKE ACCOUNTABILITY. This administration needs to own how its actions have created the climate of contentiousness and distrust on campus. Staff were apparently instructed to report on faculty heard speaking about the state of the institution. It is mind boggling that the administration that created the culture of anxiety and distrust also wants to punish us for trying to deal with it, and creates division by putting staff in the position of monitoring and reporting on faculty. TELL THE TRUTH. This includes not telling half or partial truths, or lies of omission. Be honest about what you do and do not know. Faculty cannot be equal partners in running this institution otherwise.

- Admit mistakes were made (shoving GenEd down our throats, ignoring student emotional needs during the height of pandemic, the first program review reveal, press conferences setting up vague firing plans) without being defensive. Stop communicating through press conference, communicate clearly and reasonably when there is a plan (if there are even plans). Invite faculty to discussions, all faculty, not just the loud ones or the charismatic ones.
- Remain transparent Don't be around bush Embrace the facts of the situation(s)
- Speak honestly with faculty and staff. Encourage administrators to treat faculty and staff humanely. Invite faculty and staff to participate in decision making in meaningful ways.
- 1. Halt either the retrenchment process or the academic portfolio review process until 2027, when programmatic retrenchments will be allowed again. Trying to do both while pretending they are--or can be--unrelated is nonsensical and adds to the chaotic atmosphere of fear and uncertainty at this institution. 2. When opening a negotiation process on changes to the university, frame it as a negotiation process, not a notice. "Something has to change, so how about these things? What do you think?" instead of "Such-and-so program will be deactivated" or "Line X will be eliminated." This accords respect and a voice to those who are affected. 3. Furnish all requested documents to the union immediately when they are requested. Dragging your feet on this gives the impression you have something to hide, and then speculation runs rampant about what you might be hiding and why, adding to the atmosphere of fear.
- Clear and consistent communication; more good news reports; highlight successful programs; invest in successful programs.
- 1. Change the leadership at the Top, i.e, the President. 2. Change the Chair of the Board of Trustees. 2. Reveal the true condition of the University's finances.
- Unclear
- More transparent
- Not sure what can be done now other than hopefully survive.

### III. Staff Responses

| How would you characterize Utica University for faculty and staff? | Responses | Percent |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Almost always welcoming                                            | 27        | 20.93%  |
| Often welcoming                                                    | 59        | 45.74%  |
| Sometimes welcoming                                                | 38        | 29.93%  |
| Rarely welcoming                                                   | 5         | 3.88%   |
| Almost never welcoming                                             | 0         | 0       |

| How satisfied are you with the overall work environment at Utica University? | Responses | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                               | 11        | 8.53%   |
| Satisfied                                                                    | 51        | 39.53%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                           | 34        | 26.36%  |
| Dissatisfied                                                                 | 29        | 22.48%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                            | 4         | 3.10%   |

| How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by your department?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Highly valued                                                                 | 55        | 42.64%  |
| Valued                                                                        | 46        | 35.66%  |
| Neutral                                                                       | 18        | 13.95%  |
| Not valued                                                                    | 6         | 4.65%   |
| Not valued at all                                                             | 4         | 3.10%   |

| How well do you feel your contributions are valued <u>by the institution?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Highly valued                                                                 | 8         | 6.25%   |
| Valued                                                                        | 34        | 26.56%  |
| Neutral                                                                       | 42        | 32.81%  |
| Not valued                                                                    | 33        | 25.78%  |
| Not valued at all                                                             | 11        | 8.59%   |

| Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive <u>from your department?</u> | Responses | Percent |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Excellent                                                                                              | 52        | 40.63%  |
| Good                                                                                                   | 48        | 37.50%  |
| Fair                                                                                                   | 19        | 14.84%  |
| Poor                                                                                                   | 6         | 4.69%   |
| Very poor                                                                                              | 3         | 2.34%   |

| <b>Other than financial, how would you rate the level of support you receive from the institution?</b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Excellent                                                                                              | 8                | 6.25%          |
| Good                                                                                                   | 35               | 27.34%         |
| Fair                                                                                                   | 43               | 33.59%         |
| Poor                                                                                                   | 33               | 25.78%         |
| Very poor                                                                                              | 9                | 7.03%          |

| <b>To what extent do you agree with the following statements?</b>                                       | <b>Strongly agree</b> | <b>Agree</b> | <b>Neither agree nor disagree</b> | <b>Disagree</b> | <b>Strongly disagree</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| The institution encourages you to have a voice and express concerns openly.                             | 7.81%                 | 39.84%       | 31.25%                            | 17.97%          | 3.13%                    |
| The institution provides you with opportunities to share thoughts and feelings about issues of concern. | 7.09%                 | 48.03%       | 26.77%                            | 12.60%          | 5.51%                    |
| I feel respected by the University President.                                                           | 14.96%                | 37.80%       | 29.92%                            | 11.02%          | 6.30%                    |
| I feel respected by the University Provost.                                                             | 16.54%                | 38.58%       | 34.65%                            | 7.09%           | 3.15%                    |
| I feel respected by other senior administrators.                                                        | 11.11%                | 40.48%       | 33.33%                            | 12.70%          | 2.38%                    |
| I feel respected by my colleagues.                                                                      | 31.50%                | 52.76%       | 8.66%                             | 4.72%           | 2.36%                    |
| My work responsibilities are clearly defined.                                                           | 24.41%                | 46.46%       | 11.02%                            | 13.39%          | 4.72%                    |
| My workload is manageable.                                                                              | 14.17%                | 34.65%       | 22.83%                            | 19.69%          | 8.66%                    |
| I have the resources needed to do my job effectively.                                                   | 5.51%                 | 33.07%       | 26.77%                            | 25.20%          | 9.45%                    |
| I often feel stressed or overwhelmed at work.                                                           | 17.32%                | 34.65%       | 24.41%                            | 18.90%          | 4.72%                    |

| <b>How effective is the institution's communication regarding important updates and changes?</b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Percent</b> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Extremely effective                                                                              | 5                | 3.91%          |
| Very effective                                                                                   | 19               | 14.84%         |
| Somewhat effective                                                                               | 57               | 44.53%         |
| Not so effective                                                                                 | 37               | 28.91%         |
| Not at all effective                                                                             | 10               | 7.81%          |

| <b>What are your preferred methods of communication? (Check all that apply.)</b> | <b>Responses</b> | <b>Response Percent</b> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------|
| Global emails                                                                    | 100              | 26.45%                  |
| Morning Mention                                                                  | 52               | 13.75%                  |
| Communications from various affiliate groups (e.g., AAUP, PSAC)                  | 42               | 11.11%                  |
| Discussions with supervisor, department, or school                               | 93               | 24.60%                  |
| 1:1 meeting with a member of the University's senior leadership                  | 35               | 9.25%                   |
| Small group discussions with administrative offices or senior leadership.        | 56               | 14.81%                  |

| How effective is the University's President when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                           | 11        | 8.73%   |
| Very effective                                                                                                | 36        | 28.57%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                            | 47        | 37.30%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                              | 22        | 17.46%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                          | 10        | 7.94%   |

| How effective is the University's Provost when it comes to addressing challenges the institution is facing? | Responses | Percent |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Extremely effective                                                                                         | 12        | 9.60%   |
| Very effective                                                                                              | 41        | 32.80%  |
| Somewhat effective                                                                                          | 52        | 41.60%  |
| Not so effective                                                                                            | 14        | 11.20%  |
| Not at all effective                                                                                        | 6         | 4.80%   |

| To what extent do you feel the University's leadership team cares about your well-being? | Response | Percent |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|
| A great deal                                                                             | 7        | 5.47%   |
| A lot                                                                                    | 20       | 15.63%  |
| A moderate amount                                                                        | 48       | 37.50%  |
| A little                                                                                 | 27       | 21.09%  |
| None at all                                                                              | 26       | 20.31%  |

| How satisfied are you with the professional development opportunities available at the institution? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Very satisfied                                                                                      | 2         | 1.56%   |
| Satisfied                                                                                           | 16        | 12.50%  |
| Neither satisfied nor dissatisfied                                                                  | 46        | 35.94%  |
| Dissatisfied                                                                                        | 39        | 30.47%  |
| Very dissatisfied                                                                                   | 25        | 19.53%  |

| How much of an impact does each of the following have on your morale? | A great deal | Much   | Some   | Slight | Not at all |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------|--------|--------|------------|
| Salary                                                                | 53.13%       | 25.00% | 19.53% | 1.56%  | 0.78%      |
| Benefits                                                              | 51.97%       | 29.13% | 14.96% | 2.36%  | 1.57%      |
| Feelings of belonging                                                 | 32.80%       | 36.00% | 20.00% | 4.00%  | 7.20%      |
| Feeling valued                                                        | 52.38%       | 30.95% | 11.90% | 2.38%  | 2.38%      |
| Workload                                                              | 33.07%       | 27.56% | 27.56% | 7.87%  | 3.94%      |
| Staffing levels                                                       | 43.31%       | 29.92% | 19.69% | 5.51%  | 1.57%      |
| Resources (e.g., systems, software, departmental budget)              | 33.07%       | 29.92% | 25.98% | 7.87%  | 3.15%      |

| How much of an impact does each of the following have on your morale? | A great deal | Much   | Some   | Slight | Not at all |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------|--------|--------|------------|
| Facilities                                                            | 16.33%       | 26.53% | 33.06% | 15.10% | 8.98%      |
| Institutional policies and procedures                                 | 22.22%       | 31.28% | 31.69% | 10.29% | 4.53%      |

### Other Circumstances Impacting Morale

- My answers reflect positively on my morale.
- I've noticed that my morale is often affected by the overall pace and level of engagement within our division's leadership. Our division leader is frequently away from the office, and when present, often appears preoccupied with other priorities. At the director level, while he is kind and approachable, there are noticeable gaps in the skill set required for certain responsibilities. As a result, much of the additional workload tends to fall on entry-level staff, which has become increasingly unsustainable over time.
- It's exhausting to have to work full time and then go work a second job just to make ends meet for single income. At this stage of my life, 50's, I should be doubling my money for retirement instead of trying to make ends meet.
- job security/longevity of the university; interoffice support/cooperation
- TIAA-Cref Retirement Match
- Short staffed since COVID is the biggest item on my list- I am basically doing all of the duties of the position we did not hire back and not able to do more of my job description and higher level duties. Regarding facilities it has bothered me in the past that we have worked through no heat or no air conditioning - I feel that it is just expected - and sometimes it went on for days with no word from anybody on what was going on.
- accountability, people showing up for work & pulling their weight
- Opportunities for advancement, inclusivity
- Faculty's voice (via the Union) carrying far more weight than that of the Staff.
- There seems to be a caste system within the Institution.

| Approximately how long have your concerns affected your morale? | Responses | Percent |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Less than 6 months                                              | 10        | 8.40%   |
| 6 months to 1 year                                              | 22        | 18.49%  |
| 1 to 2 years                                                    | 34        | 28.57%  |
| 2-3 years                                                       | 19        | 15.96%  |
| 3 to 4 years                                                    | 12        | 10.08%  |
| 4 to 5 years                                                    | 10        | 8.40%   |
| More than 5 years                                               | 12        | 10.08%  |



**Please share any additional comments regarding the current climate at Utica University.**

- The Institution has been in financial turmoil for the last four years. There were many signs, and the decisions weren't made quickly enough to make a material impact. Some of the pain could have been minimized if decisions had been made more quickly. Why do an Academic Portfolio Review if there would be no savings generated? The Institution needs to be quicker and more nimble in reacting to the downturn in enrollments by reducing its cost structure to better align with the current revenue stream. Salaried staff members have been asked to make drastic sacrifices over the last several years, from no salary increases to freezes in employer contributions to retirement, to pay cuts on more than one occasion, if you were over a certain threshold. It is hard to stay motivated to work hard when there is no incentive. Hourly staff have also sacrificed with no raises, if they were above the minimum wage; yet, exempt staff continue to be bumped each year to the NYS minimum. Additionally, some departments have been extremely disciplined in cost control, holding the line on positions and trying to figure out how to do more with less. In other departments, as soon as an opening arises, the position ends up being posted. It sends mixed messaging across campus and makes other departments not feel as valued. Perhaps more job sharing should be looked at. Our units have not been able to network and attend professional conferences. This has put us behind in the industry.
- I feel very disconnected with other divisions and departments. I don't know anyone in admissions, and it feels cold over there. I'd love to have a better relationship with that team because I think we could all help with recruitment, enhanced tours, and most importantly- info about the incoming class, their needs, trends, numbers, important tasks and dates, etc. If you call and ask about this stuff, they seem offended. We need strong leaders/VPs that work well together and can connect us all regularly. It is so vital that we all know and understand what we're all doing so we look like we are a cohesive unit.
- The workload has been difficult due to COVID and the staff shortages. I feel stressed at times to take vacation, or days off due to feeling ill. I know this has been a difficult time for everyone. I truly believe the Administration is working to find the best solutions for the University. I do feel those making under \$20.00 feels a greater impact then most. If possible, it would have meant a lot if the furlough could possibly have been waived for them. Overall, I have enjoyed very much working at Utica College/Utica University . There is a strong feeling of closeness among the faculty and staff I work with. It feels like a family.
- The lack of professionalism and collegiality of the faculty needs to be addressed. Staff have been challenged about FlexTime but the amount of closed faculty doors during non-teaching hours is infuriating. For staff, this is our primary occupation. For faculty this is one income stream and, in some cases, secondary income streams have taken priority. Emails go unanswered, students feel ignored. Out of frustration students turn to staff and

we must intervene, sometimes never getting a response from faculty at all. Policy and procedures are ignored. Changes are implemented without any consultation to see if those changes can be supported. There have been actions taken by faculty in an attempt to get the attention of the administration that ultimately made staff feel utterly embarrassed and used.

- I have worked at the University for just about 17 yrs now and I have nothing to show for it. I have not gotten over a \$3 raise all this time and I don't take my flex time because most of the time I am needed in the office. I don't take my hour lunch I eat when I can most of the time I eat on the run. And I have a lot of sugar issues and migraines so I need to eat and sometimes feels like I have going to pass out because my sugar drops. I live paycheck to paycheck and this week we have to take off is going to kill me . I have only myself and I am taking care of an adult son with major mental health issues I can't afford to lose all this money. People that work at McDonald's make as much or even more than I do hired as a professional I stay because of our kids I want to be there for them and they count on me
- Not filling positions when people exit and instead moving their work to other employees, allowing teams to shrink smaller and smaller but with the same or increased demands for output, are a large part in the problem of low morale. Teamed with recent discussions about changing or doing away with flex time (a compensation for the inability to offer raises or increased pay) is a recipe for poor morale and a depressed workforce. Continuing with these patterns will results in the loss of good, talented people who will go elsewhere.
- To have your retirement continuously be taken away as a staff member is very discouraging. Retirement contributions by the University help to offset the extremely low salaries. If flex time is also taken away it will be very detrimental to my family obligations and also help to offset the low salary, furlough, and retirement contributions.
- The campus has become an 'us vs them' in many ways. Faculty vs Staff; Administration vs Faculty/Staff. We are all here for students but so many have forgotten that. If our institution needs to change to stay relevant and to remain open, then that is the most important thing. It shouldn't matter that you have 27 faculty screaming, if those programs are not fulfilling the needs of campus they should be removed. Many staff have lost their positions, people are furloughed (again); positions haven't been filled for years... we are at war with each other on campus and that isn't healthy. People are worried about losing their job, or what may be announced next.
- Budget constraints, salary and TIAA cutbacks have greatly affected the morale of the staff.
- Since I have begun I have watched us stop getting raises for performance, watched long time employees let go, had my job description change 5 times, have had extra caseload added each year, lost retirement, now a furlough week and discussion of changing flex. Also almost every single pay bump I received during my time here was immediately

equated by the increase in minimum salary from the state. It feels like I get this "bump" to try and increase morale just to hide that its going to happen anyways with minimum going up. Getting paid essentially the same as an entry level in my department for four years was extremely morale breaking. If it were not for the flex time, I would no longer be here in all honesty.

- The cuts in staffing have increased workload for most. Increased workload with salary and benefit cuts (also no raises) is difficult on morale. Also, staff is the first to suffer cuts when there is a budget shortfall. Staff feels taken advantage of year after year.
- It seems departments work in silos and don't interact outside of their area.
- I like a lot of things about working here. My coworkers are wonderful and I love the students. But the precarity of the institution is increasingly stressful and it feels like everyone is feeling it, including the students. I also think that people here struggle with boundaries. I see this with everyone: staff, faculty, students. This a "give more than your all" attitude that results in a lot of wonderful generosity but also intense burnout and resentment. I think many feel we must give more and more with less and less given to us. Our students, while fewer in number, are higher and higher in need in terms of needing extra support. It might help to think of staffing in terms of not just number of people, but demand on services.
- The current atmosphere at Utica University reflects a deep concern among students and staff—many are either genuinely distressed about the University's situation or are maintaining a brave face despite underlying worries.
- Campus safety is very phobic, to students but even to faculty, staff and it's own staff
- Climate is not great. However, staff and faculty are wonderful to each other and I feel a good sense of belonging.
- Great place.
- Love it here so far, very welcoming!
- While I understand the institution is in a financial crisis, it is unfortunate that finances will be the number one way to demoralize a community. Cutting benefits, retirement matching, and a forced furlough is hard to overweigh with any smaller movements.
- I know staffing has to be "right sized" but we've lost so many that it means we can't always provide good service to students. That isn't going to help retention and the bottom line.
- It's stressful with so much being up in the air. different things are mentioned and never elaborated on, so you are never sure what is exactly going to happen to you or your position.
- 1) Communication & Marketing are problems. I feel that the University does not share relevant information to faculty, staff and students that impact the day to day climate. 2) We also lack a vision, clear mission and steps/plan to reach our goals. The IEP was good in theory but I don't feel like anyone other than Sr. Leadership had a part in the IEP or the

execution of seeing things accomplished. The fact that staff were not included in the Re-Envisioning discussions speaks volumes to the complete disregard and lack of inclusion with staff. 3) Faculty are bullies. There is a huge problem with the way that faculty members treat staff members. Faculty members often talk to staff members as if staff are below the faculty and that the staff members work for them.

- Words and actions at the University need stronger alignment. For example, staff from Career Readiness were furloughed in 2024 to support financial recovery, yet the 2025 Re-Envisioning Utica plan highlights career readiness as a strategic priority. This contradiction gave the impression of either limited strategic planning or a lack of consistency in decision-making. Regardless of intent, it had a noticeable impact on staff morale and confidence in leadership. Greater transparency and coherence between stated goals and operational actions would help restore trust and engagement among employees.
- I don't have much to say but while I know the university struggles financially, please pay me more money. Not trying to be greedy but \$16.40 does not cover all my bills.
- I face challenges doing my job when people in other offices are not available. It is difficult to get anyone on the telephone. The excuse across campus is that "we are understaffed." And that is valid because we all feel it. But after facing continuous roadblocks with no action, people just stop caring and it causes low morale.
- The constant changing of our benefits package (taking away retirement), furlough, the idea of flex going away or being cut back, the lack of job security really makes morale low and adds an extreme amount to the stress of every day life.
- I feel as though there's little to no communication about what's going on or why we're in this mess.
- N/A
- I feel the campus never regained the atmosphere it had pre-covid. Previously it seemed there were more campus events and activities during the day that employees could see or even join in. Petting zoos, Squirrel Day, the chem dept making liquid nitrogen ice cream, telescopes for an eclipse. It made me so glad to work at a college instead of a corporation. No one seems to be having fun anymore; it doesn't feel like a community and much more like any office job. Staff doesn't get to interact with other staff or students outside of emails and meetings.
- Because there is a silo feeling between staff and faculty, it is difficult to put us in the same survey and ask the same information. It is very disheartening that it feels like the staff is continually asked to give because the faculty has a union behind them. Currently, I enjoy the individuals I work with everyday and wish that they were recognized in a better light, especially when it comes to competitive pay (compared to other offices on campus and other institutions). Over the 14 years I have been here, I have seen many iterations of morale both in the office and on campus, and it has been difficult to watch

administrations ask for sacrifices but never truly speak to or know how those sacrifices would affect the office, individuals and perhaps, their families.

- I think its tough being in a department that is going above and beyond what is being asked of them and all we get back is "you're doing a great job." we need more than that and if that is all that can be given right now so be it, but departments (as a whole) not pulling their weight or doing what they need to do needs to be more firmly addressed and I think it's everyone's business what is being told to each department.
- Incorrectly referring to the "Professional Staff Advisory Committee" (Council) in an email regarding morale is more than slightly ironic, and the perceived lack of recognition is precisely a core issue.
- My main concern, and probably only concern (aside from the possibility of closure if we can't balance the budget) is regarding Flex Time. I do not want to lose it.
- I think it's going to be very difficult to change the morale when staff are constantly making scarifies to their pay, retirement, and now FlexTime.
- I think during challenging times, it's already scary, then we struggle with loss (being furloughed, benefits, even people you may have worked with for years). If there are any opportunities to feel like you "get something" - I think it goes a long way.
- I think there are people that are feeling very negative and it does cause a heaviness on campus. For what it's worth, I feel like despite the changes and challenges since I've been here, I like coming to work here and love the students. I don't think the negativity should spill over to students and their experiences. I hope that we can all get back to the center of why we are here and be creative in our thinking and work to make this experience positive for all of our students. I give credit to the leadership team for guiding us through this, it can't be easy to make the decisions that affect so many. I don't know how to change others feelings but I will continue to stay positive and keep perspective.
- It is hard to stay positive when morale is down across the board due to staffing cuts, etc. It is just spiraling out of control- the longer we do not hire, the more work there is for the rest of us and the less time we can take,etc
- I feel so bad that the University is going what it's going through right now. I love what I do, and I love working here. I remain optimistic that things will improve! I think that there are a lot of people working here that feel the same way...that they are here because they love this place! Leadership has a hard job to do but I think they can do it. For me personally, I have been here for 18+ years and in my current position for 12 years. I get outstanding performance reviews. In my current role, I continue to take on more and more work, and I am OK with that - I truly am. The hard part is...the largest increase I have ever received has only been due to laws that say I have to be at a certain salary. I have never received even a title change when I have taken on work that my previous boss and other department members once did. It's hard when others in your department get raises, get title changes and here I sit. It's also hard when I see people making a heck of a

lot more money than I make, and, if I'm being honest....not even doing all that they should be doing as far as what's required of them in their job. Other people are asked to do the tasks that this person should be doing, because it isn't trusted that they can do what they should be doing. I'm sure this sounds confusing....but it actually is confusing to me, too! Having said all of that, I continue to do what I do because it makes me happy, and I do feel that I am making a difference, and this is where I want to be!

- When I first started here over 11 years ago, I felt like I walked into a family. Since then, things have changed and now I feel like departments are divided. I'm not sure how to changes this going forward, but love to get that feeling back on campus again.
- My pay is a dollar above minimum wage, with a bachelors degree and two years of full time experience here. I cannot afford to rent or live anywhere on my own with this wage, I can barely afford groceries. I stay because I love my coworkers, I like the flex day and tuition benefits, and I like what I do for the students and community here.
- There seems to be a general apathy among staff. People complain but nobody actively makes changes. People ignore directives.
- I am a new employee. I have worked in other sectors. The community here, those of long standing, do not respect that industry change driving institutional change is a necessary part of managing a system effectively. They present as entitled, rude and self absorbed. Some people in management positions are not manager material at all. Experience with a department does not translate to effective leadership of said department. When discussing faculty reductions in particular, they do not understand the big picture, if a program does not have students, the program is not viable. They also don't seem to want to understand that while their office may need more people, that does not mean that no cuts should be made. Some departments are not interchangeable and moving people laterally may not be most efficient or that person may not be qualified in another area. As a new employee that has worked in the private sector, and also seen their alma matter shuttered, I have perhaps a less biased opinion or perspective on the situation. There seems to be a pile on mentality in those faculty/staff meetings and some of those comments are very unprofessional
- While there are "opportunities" for us to speak at forums or financial town halls, it does not feel safe to do so. Senior leadership respond to critiques or frustrations in a way that comes across as defensive. I am not as open or direct as I could be because I fear professional repercussions for speaking out.
- As a newer employee, it was made clear to me early on that staff were not happy here. After seeing the cuts to TIAA contributions and the week of furlough, as well as seeing the workload of some of my colleagues, I can see why many people feel drained here.
- i believe there is a disconnect between the haves and the have nots.
- My department has extreme issues with staff that are and act racist, sexist, transphobic and overall bigoted and the institution has shown decreasing interest in support. The



institution has also seemed to lose opportunities for advancement and in discussion of my department, they have specified there is no positions above entry level and the few positions at and above living wage are being held and guarded by problematic individuals who intend to stay into retirement. The staff shortage and salary positions not being filled has forced the majority of my department to do work well exceeding actual job description, for less pay and respect than the supervisor positions. There is an increasing sense of hostility tied to an understanding that there is no room for growth or raises, forcing good employees out and I know in my department, it has grown a problematic bubble where bigotted individuals stay and anyone well meaning is pressed out.

- 1) You can say that morale problems started before the recent program cuts and TIAA freezes, but instances such as those were very much happening before July 1st. These actions have been happening since the first round of program cuts in 2023, and there are a decent bit of employees who have only been here long enough to see almost nothing but cuts and uncertainty. 2) Half the reason there's been a drop in enrollment for programs such as the History major is because you don't promote them. The last time the university even posted anything related to the history program on its Instagram, for instance, was when the Russia-Ukraine War started over three years ago. In April of this year students taking HIS-456 gave presentations on their senior theses in the form of an actual symposium. Where was the social media post about that? Why were there no administrative staff members present to show their support for these students? Yes, faculty in these programs should play a part in promoting these events and what the programs offer too, but the University plays a vital role in making sure people actually know what it offers. It costs nothing to make a Facebook or Instagram post every once in a while. Potential students of history, sociology, and the like will be lost to Hamilton, Oneonta, Syracuse, etc. 3) Focusing so much on things like STEM when studies are showing that the job market for those fields is in an abysmal state (NBC, CBS, Money.com), shows a disconnect to both the student population and the staff/faculty. Those fields are of course needed, but it's a disservice to the university as a whole to focus so hard on those fields when the data is showing an increasingly difficult job market. <https://www.nbcnews.com/business/economy/job-market-report-college-student-graduates-ai-trump-tariffs-rcna221693> <https://www.cbsnews.com/news/ai-jobs-unemployment-college-graduate/> <https://money.com/college-grads-stem-degrees-unemployed/>
- The sports fields are getting too much care given to them, the rest of the university is floundering in appearance and maintenance
- I think the overall lack of communication between departments makes things very difficult. I find that there is a lot of "gate keeping" of information between departments.
- As a campus, I believe a major component of the low morale is related to perceived inequity in pay, workload, and effectiveness across various departments. Without saying names, some departments (and individuals) seem to have a much stronger work ethic and



a much heavier workload than others. Additionally, there is a disproportionately high number of higher-level administrators at this University. Certain people, in particular, seem to get promotion after promotion in high-level positions without putting in the same levelZero team building in athletics. Across the board measures and actions are archaic methods of leadership.

- I honestly don't even know where to begin. Regardless of the University's current financial situation, I'm still grateful to work here. I love my job and my department! Everyone is so kind and genuine. It's heartbreaking to see everyone so stressed, and with their plates so full. I feel like I live in a constant state of anxiety. I'm always worried about the University's financial situation, and what it means for us as staff, and the students and faculty. The furlough announcement really stressed me out as I live paycheck to paycheck. I'm worried what could be next. For once I am scared as an at will employee. I understand difficult decisions have to be made and I want to do what I can. But I'm worried these changes are happening without full consideration of how it affects the lower end of staff. I of dedication and commitment, or even relevant experience, to said positions.
- My immediate work surroundings, in terms of people, are good. Big picture, I think there is only so long people can stand feeling like the institution is on the precipice of destruction and that many people in senior positions are responsible for aspects of that predicament and are not held accountable for it. It starts at the top. I respect the Provost for tackling the real crisis and being honest. The President has dithered and evaded and kicked the can and is not accountable or trustworthy at all. Faculty entitlement is another problem. They don't appreciate their privilege. They need to be part of the solution.
- I had a student who works in our office tell me about how one of her professors was talking to his class about being worried that he would lose his job. I know things haven't been great lately, but I really feel it is wrong to be talking about this with students. Our students should not have to worry about or be affected by staff/faculty cuts. I could tell it made this student feel uncomfortable. Perhaps interactions like this are contributing to our lower than expected retention. It bothers me that this kind of thing is being shared with students. They already have so much to worry about in trying to be successful, and now some members of our community are sharing their own burdens with others. It just feels wrong to me.
- I feel like some departments either just don't work together with others properly, or some departments just like to dump work on others instead of taking the time to help or do their job effectively. There is not good collaboration here. There never seems to be an exact set way of doing things here or any form of procedure. Things are constantly changing, and I feel like it's hardly ever for the better. It's just a lot to keep up with. There is a stress/anxiety around the whole campus that always feels palpable. I feel disrespected by Utica's high-level leadership, saying that FlexWork should either be changed or that current benefits/time off should be changed to match with other companies around the

area. It just feels like they keep beating us down and don't respect us or all the work we do. Not only do I feel we get paid somewhat poorly for the current state of the economy and the work we do, some benefits keep getting taken away, and many of us never know if we are getting let go next. I feel like the President will say one thing and do another sometimes. Nothing is ever very clear. FlexWork is really one of the main things keeping people here right now. I honestly love Utica and working with students/people here, but the work environment is not conducive for anyone to work well or want to stay long-term. Leadership says we are overstaffed, but I beg to differ. Most offices could use way more help/hands on deck for the amount of traffic they see. Other than from my own department, I never really feel like the University cares about the work I do, and it's upsetting. With the constant negatives going on lately, the climate is obviously bad here right now (hence, the reason for this survey in the first place). I'm hopeful things can start to change for the better soon and I think it all starts with leadership making better decisions that won't hurt the rest of us. With the amount of debt the university was in, according to leadership, it seems like multiple poor decisions have been made in the past, and now the consequences are falling on all of us while high-level leadership doesn't share in it. They get upset when the community thinks that we are going to close and voices concerns about it, but what do you expect?

- I understand why difficult decisions are being made re: salary and benefits but if a department feels they have a strong case to be made for exception, I don't feel that it is fielded with sincerity.
- I surround myself who want to be here at the University and want to see it succeed. I know who the "doers" are on this campus and who are not! I am sick of people complaining about the poor culture but doing nothing to try to change it.
- I think the overall morale is very good here. Frankly it's the first place I've worked that isn't horridly toxic which is kudos to everyone that has worked here for so long and genuinely cares about the students, each other and the organization. - BUT having to give up retirement benefits and pay year after year takes it's toll. I fear we will lose good people because they just won't be able to afford to continue working here. The cost of everything around us is going up quite a bit and our pay is going down. That is only sustainable for so long.
- I understand that the university is in survival mode now. Should the university actually survive, I do not believe that the administration is willing to make the changes necessary to keep from being back in this same position within the next decade, by holding those who got us in this position to account, or to create any culture of accountability necessary for a successful future.
- The ongoing uncertainty of the University's financial stability has been consistently unsettling.
- I am relatively new here and accepted this job already taking a pay cut because I was really excited about the work. The recent announcements about sacrifices all faculty and

staff are making felt disingenuous that these concerns were not brought up openly when I was interviewing and accepted this job. If I had known the pay cut I already took would be cut even more through lack of benefits and furlough I likely would not have taken this job. The feelings of not knowing what might be next are making it hard to see myself in this position long term. That being said all of the faculty and staff that I work with and have encountered being friendly and welcoming has been a big plus to these other stressors.

- People here are "nice but not kind." Everyone goes through the pleasantries and offers to be collaborative, but rarely do people come to the table with the willingness to take action. I understand this is likely from burnout and lack of staffing, but it makes it very disheartening when trying to innovate. People can say they value you, but where is the action behind this? Decisions are seemingly made in vacuums, where the players you would expect to be making decisions are somehow left out - I feel some people are letting power go to their heads. For example, who is on the HR Subcommittee, or Space Committee? Why are they deciding the fate of my operation without me or my supervisor? This mysteriousness only worsens the silo effect (seriously, why is it so divided when we have a small campus and limited resources?!) and feelings of being devalued.
- The burden put on the staff, not "voted" on, as a result of the institution's current financial situation has far surpassed that in which has been placed onto the faculty - to a point where the division can very much feel like an "us versus them" situation. Naturally, this has been very negative to the campus climate. As a staff member, I have at times felt undervalued by the University's leadership over the last 2-3 years. I've also felt disrespected by faculty members who seem to have a complete lack of an understanding for what we do and the burdens that have been placed on staff during this timeframe.
- My morale drops whenever I have to tell a student that they can't take X class or pursue X major because it is no longer offered. This is not something we track but I think we ought to. I understand the austerity measures but I can't help but feel like what makes this institution unique is being gutted. If all we can offer students are liberal arts degrees dressed up to look like pre-professional programs, then I don't blame them for leaving. Why not just go to trade school at that point? If we are a liberal arts school, we should offer a more robust liberal arts curriculum. I think when students look around and see that they can't even take a foreign language class anymore, it makes them feel like they are at a sub-par institution.
- Flex work was instituted when we weren't given raises. Recently, talk about flex work has many concerned that there may be a plan being considered to remove it. Overloaded work schedules often make it so we have to work during our flex time regardless, but the loss of this time would be detrimental to morale. Last year, benefits were cut, then reinstated. However, now they've been cut again. This has many very concerned that the financial situation of the institute is worse than we were led to believe. Recent

management moves leave us working harder than ever to meet the needs to students, while feeling very unsure about the future of our careers.

- Current climate, I feel, is that we need to be better as an institution and be welcoming and helpful to the students. Students are the reason we are here. Many times when I cover the helpdesk, I get students calling who are lost and need guidance.
- I think the staffing levels are of great concern. I think we were starting to run lean in areas years prior to our most recent budget issues. This last crunch feels like dangerous territory. If people go out or leave there is no historical knowledge/skill transfer, or appropriate coverage.
- I think it is fair to conclude that being in a better financial position will help immensely but that is not something that happens overnight. Cuts and freezes over the years have been chipping away at morale leaving people on edge and strapped for resources. And, unfortunately, negativity breeds negativity. Senior leadership are doing the best they can with what they have, which is not much. I think people lose sight of the fact senior leaders are people too. People also get upset about not having a voice, but from my perspective, don't take advantage of the opportunities for their voice to be heard unless it's an anonymous survey.
- I think that staff cuts have started long before all of these other cuts went into effect. Since pandemic cuts, I have noticed a big difference in morale among myself, and then it has only gotten worse over time. I do not blame the people in charge necessarily, because I know they are great people and doing the best they can, but the situation overall just continues to deeply change my morale. For question 15, the "Great deal" categories (other than staffing) that I chose are not 4-5 years but the past 1-2 years. They were "some" prior to the past 2 years but have become a lot more prevalent of concerns.
- I feel that leadership does care for faculty/staff and the environment at Utica, but are very limited in what they can do to improve the overall work environment.
- It's horrible. Almost ALL of the senior leadership over the last 5 years have left the college to find other jobs. It seems they foresaw the current environment and jumped ship taking all of the lifeboats with them.
- inflation has increased over 20% in the last 5 years and we have had only one cost of living increase. Also, our retirement contribution was taken away several times. Yet, we are expected to do more with less. The people are generally very nice. The problem is the lack of pay increase and workload.
- As an alum, I am very proud to work here, and would consider myself a high-morale employee.
- Our team is currently operating with only two people, despite typically having four. If the other two positions are not going to be filled, then the additional workload should be recognized with appropriate compensation, ideally through a pay increase that reflects the responsibilities of the unfilled roles. I've been carrying the workload of two additional

team members, which has required constant learning, long hours, and has left little to no time to catch up, no matter how hard I work.

- While I understand changes to salaries and benefits were made to resolve the unbalanced budget, this has led to increasing frustration in my area of work with myself and my team. People do not feel like their jobs are secure, and fear for what the future holds.
- The uncertainty and financial concern seems to be making the overall morale worse in the last two months.
- The staff at Utica is amazing. I can walk into an office and get help whenever I need. The faculty are rude to the staff and students and will not help me or other success coaches with much of anything. The president comes across as very selfish and close-minded. I have met with him a handful of times, and he still does not know my name or position. Coming from a college like Hamilton, this is very jarring for me
- It is difficult when we see some departments are able to replace positions, but other departments have positions that are not being posted.

**Please list 3 ways the institution's leadership team might improve the morale at Utica University.**

- The leadership team needs to take action on what they say they will do within the established timeframe. More opportunities to meet with the leadership team would be helpful. The Incoming President's meetings this week allowed people with the opportunity to hear from her directly, in a smaller environment.
- Receiving genuine thank-yous from administration would help. Not just a thank you after delivering bad/negative news. There doesn't need to be anything attached to the thank you. Just say thank you once in a while. I truly don't know how else to improve morale until things become more stable at this institution.
- 1 - there is very much a sense of "bare minimum is fine" right now. And those of us working hard to improve the student experience, meet goals, boost morale, keep up with best practice, etc. look around at depts/people doing bare minimum and feel resentment. I think it's time to do a true deep dive into where we're lacking. 2- we all want to feel like we belong to something bigger than ourselves. Let's get together as staff/employees more- monthly happy hours, staff nights at hockey games, on campus professional development days (this was promised by Todd during his campaign), more recognition for hard work or going the extra mile, staff highlights on new projects, community service, etc. 3- it very much feels like there's 3-4 people in a locked room making all of the decisions. I think staff and students have really good ideas that should be heard. Would love to see focus groups and more working groups to share ideas.
- >Communication on this campus is appalling. The siloing is to our detriment. Uninformed decision making has cost the institution dearly. Invite all the stakeholders to the table. >Accept the demographics of what this institution is and the students that

choose to attend here, commit to it, then build the support(s) to meet their needs. Our students need curriculum to be taught, not just delivered. We need to get back the community we once were. Admissions sells a close knit, family atmosphere, we are not delivering. It's very, very easy to check the box "financial" as the reason for leaving when families just want to remove their child from here and give little explanation to avoid pushback. >We need more qualified staff to support the technical infrastructure of the campus and meet the demands of the offices crucial to the institution.

- Don't take away a work week ... Pay into our retirement... Make us feel needed and that we are safe in our positions
- Fill roles when people exit. Not filling positions and instead moving their work to other employees, allowing teams to shrink smaller and smaller but with the same or increased demands for output, are a large part in the problem of low morale. Leave the flex time situation where it is. Teamed with recent discussions about changing or doing away with flex time (a compensation for the inability to offer raises or increased pay) is a recipe for poor morale and a depressed workforce. Continuing with these patterns will results in the loss of good, talented people who will go elsewhere.
- More transparency. The unknown is what is concerning.
- providing more professional development opportunities/announcing them in places other than the morning mentions ensuring we have the software that makes our jobs easier making sure that you tell people they are doing a good job and that their work is being seen and appreciated
- When I first started here I felt like this college was the only one that was transparent. I don't feel that way anymore, I feel lied to and like so much has been hidden. We need to know the real truth, the real numbers, the real plans. We don't need more holiday parties, we need matching of 401K. This doesn't just hurt me now, it hurts my future. I'd rather a salary reduction than losing my retirement contributions. Provide employees with ways to help, one size doesn't fit all.
- Leadership teams should provide opportunities to better collaborate with each other. The departments should have a basic understanding of what each office does. There is disconnect between faculty and staff, which may has created animosity between the two groups. It could be effective to encourage more conversations. Potentially doing a lunch-in event to allow students to see the exchanges too.
- Stop combining jobs and giving people more work without any pay. It seems like those that are good at their jobs and competent are getting more and more work because they can while those that are not as on top of it get paid the same for less.
- Open Communication, meetings with each department (split by supervisor and supervisees to get a better gauge at our day to day lives and what happens in our offices), and more time off like Thanksgiving/New Years eve (half days and told ahead of time).



- Stop making staff salary and benefit cuts the first line of defense when there is a budget shortfall. Have a plan if we suffer another shortfall next year. Think of ideas that don't include staff salary and benefit cuts. Two years of cuts is enough. I've been here 11 years and have had TIAA-CREF paused for 3 of the 11 years. Rework the AAUP contract to make cuts more equal between faculty and staff during times of financial hardship. If faculty gave more, staff wouldn't have to have both salary and benefits cut. Discontinue the use it by 5/31 or lose it policy on vacation time. I have lost vacation time for the past few years because my workload is too heavy to use it all. You could do this by limiting the number of days that can be carried over and not including carried over days in vacation pay outs. I think this would help morale.
- Encourage collaboration between departments More transparency Engage staff in problem solving – subcommittees
- Have supervisors encourage good boundary making as much as possible to reduce burnout. It's true that the 'go beyond your boundaries' is a big workplace culture thing here IMO, so this will likely take a lot of work. Make sure everyone can use flex time. Don't reduce the PTO. The comparison to other institutions in communications isn't effective: other institutions might have less time off, but they also have better pay and far better health benefits and retirement. They have more stability. Give more notice for important meetings and communicate more widely. I had to work late after the financial town hall because I had to push things around in my schedule due to the last min notice and that was an unnecessary component of that whole demoralizing experience.
- Address faculty and staff who do not contribute positively to the campus environment. Hold employees accountable for fulfilling their job responsibilities. Evaluate and address the performance of supervisors who fail to provide adequate training, guidance, or support to their teams. When employees' questions are ignored or dismissed, it often leads to confusion, mistakes, and delays in completing tasks.
- Better pay Addressing phobic people in supervisor roles and in general Better positions
- 1. Get the university on solid financial footing. 2. Find ways to increase faculty and staff participation (and students) in activities. 3. Some administrative changes.
- Redistribute resources to areas of strength. Complete honesty about what is going to happen and exactly what that means. One clear set of expectations. Merit-based compensation - no guaranteed increases, increases/decreases for all based on individual performance and or institutional success.
- Quarterly financial updates Quarterly enrollment updates Quarterly improvement plan update meetings
- Continue in positive directions
- 1. Celebrate achievements 2. Create opportunities for professional development
- - Do not get rid of or decrease flexwork. In a time where additional financial benefits are not possible, personal time is even more important. While I work in an office where



flexwork is not always a possibility every week, I would still rather have it in its full capacity for those who can and for me when it is possible. - There seems to be a big disconnect between offices that should be working more cohesively together. I am not sure if some sort of 'team-bonding' would improve this, but if those relationships and willingness to work together were to improve, I think morale would as well. - Encouraging use of existing PTO. Where again additional financial benefits are not possible, time off is the next best thing. Supervisors and heads of teams should be encouraging this use of time, instead of shaming employees who try to use this benefit to its full use. While it is understandable certain offices have times of the year where it is more inconvenient to use time off, an employee should be able to use their time for personal uses without judgement from higher-up employees.

- Address the short staffing in areas that are really low on staff. I know it costs money, but its necessary to make sure we provide timely support to our "customers".
- Clear information. Seeing a positive change happen somewhere instead of just negative then being told not to talk about it.
- When changes are being made, it would be helpful to talk to the people who actually do the work and are affected by the changes. It is frustrating when a position opens and the responsibilities are just redistributed, but with no remuneration, it is very demoralizing. The term "other duties as assigned" is just used to dump more work on people.
- 1. Walk around and be present. Stop into offices and say hello. 2. Leadership needs to look and sound confident with decisions. 3. Collaborate with others. 4. Do not take Flex Time away - you will lose good people if you take it away.
- 1. Align words with actions. Ensure that institutional priorities are reflected in decisions and resource allocations to build credibility and trust. 2. Be more present and engaged. Leadership visibility and genuine interaction with staff would go a long way toward improving morale and fostering a sense of shared purpose. 3. Value and support employees. Show appreciation through fair workloads, opportunities for input, and recognition of effort, not just outcomes.
- I don't know, but please consider the people under you and the hardships they might be dealing with before making decisions like furlough or cuts.
- Provide opportunities for engagement that are not "work-dependent."
- I recognize that leadership is in an impossible position. There is no fix for this.
- Keeping flex Bring back retirement Don't furlough More team bonding Changing from semi monthly to bi weekly pay checks
- Open and honest communication. Concrete solutions. Respecting the faculty union and the staff.
- 1) I realize we can't spend money, but a little more employee appreciation could go a long way. Some of us have worked here for several years and have gotten little more than an automated "thank you" only because it's polite. 2) Really listen to what people have to

say and compromise when you can. A lot of these changes are being forced on us. Some changes, such as moving people around like it's a chess match, don't seem to have anything to do with money. It can make us feel like we are just pawns and not valued. Let the little guy have a "win" once in a while. 3) People are burnt out and don't want to go to events or hang out with co-workers. We want to disconnect from the stress. It might be worth looking into events/activities that involve the public or something we could bring our families to. That way it doesn't just feel like more work. PSAC brought up trunk or treat. I think a craft fair was mentioned too. Fitness classes, fun runs, food festivals, and art/craft classes for adults or kids usually catch interest as well. Again, money may be a concern, but it might be a way to get people to feel more like a community again.

- Team Building Events Performance Bonuses Offer More Professional Development Opportunities
- Pay us more.
- Keep flex-time in some format- work/life balance does make up for a lot. More frequent communication about the state of the university See the leadership team out and about- attending departmental meetings, have an informal brown bag lunch or coffee hour gathering with rotating departments, have them engage with the "boots on the ground" folks. It might help if people felt like the leadership understood the accomplishments and hurdles they have every day, to really saw what they do. Heck, have them work an hour in a busy (especially student facing) office- a "job swap" day.
- I think it is important that those in senior leadership truly understand what a day in each office looks like, what resources are available and what could be improved upon. So many people make judgements before they understand and know what others have to do or what they might face everyday, especially with low staff numbers and certain directives.
- - credit where credit is due beyond just saying "you're doing a great job." Even if that's a department of the month, or year or whatever it is.
- Faculty treat Staff like disposable peasants. The Faculty Union treats Utica University like a punching bag. Administration and Faculty spend so much time bickering, Staff are relegated to second-class citizens. "We wouldn't be here if it wasn't for teachers." Faculty can't flip a light switch without Staff, and Faculty Senate is a swirling torrent of negativity which spills out to social media, where most Faculty are friends with Alumni and Students. Faculty have done more to suck the morale out of this place post-Covid than anything, and they aren't contractually-obligated to lift a finger in the Summer, so they unload on staff when they return. PAY. Cost-of-living raises haven't been implemented since 2019, and people are struggling to make ends meet. Many hourly employees are making, to the penny, what they made in 2019, with no opportunity for advancement and no raise in sight. Working more isn't even an option because Overtime work is discouraged in writing but Flexibility in work is encouraged verbally - that needs to stop. The veiled threat that Flex is optional and can be taken away is tossed around

constantly by our own VP. Flex was introduced in lieu of raises from 2019 to 2025, but new hires not impacted by the lack of raises also receive Flex. We're understaffed, asked to cross-train for free, our retirement match is cut entirely not once, not twice, but three times, and we're expected to pick up the slack for the lack of staffing. Some Vice Presidents are never here, and remote workers take complete advantage of everyone by responding when they feel like. Directors don't hold anyone accountable for doing a poor job or no job at all - it just gets flexed to the good employees because we're afraid of losing anyone.

- #NAME?
- 1. Bring back school spirit Friday's. 2. Take into consideration the feedback about Flextime before making changes.
- 1. Take what is collected in this response and have the employees vote to determine the 2 most important ways to improve and try to implement. 2. Being included in orientation family picnic. I do think there should be a message that the event is to meet families and show our pride in this institution (not just friends grabbing a table to eat together). 3. Allowing offices to close to participate in major events like convocation, unity walk, commencement bridges a gap of not only a feeling of belonging but being valued. Some institutions ask all their employees to participate in convocation/ commencement - not sure everyone would love that, but I think there's a sense of being valued enough as an employee that leadership wants all employee's included in those celebrations.
- 1. Communicate 2. Provide a safe space for concerns within the faculty/staff 3. Highlight the positive things that are happening on campus.
- 1. More ways for professional development- in my case if we are allowed to hire someone I firmly believe that I will be able to take on more of my job duties and gain some professional development- in the meantime after 4-5 years I am very frustrated with this part of my job. 2. Be more understanding of staff taking vacation and flex days. If you can't OR won't take your days , keep it to yourself. Many times I have heard co-workers say they feel guilty taking their days - I have felt that way in the past and did not take some of my Flex and gave up some vacation days - and I really don't feel that it mattered much to management & did not make much of a difference with my work- the only thing it did was make me feel less appreciated. 3. Kind words go a long way- I'm not saying everyday- but more than what has been going on- I could go a whole week and NOT see or talk to the 2 top people in my department and the second in command I directly report to. I would appreciate even if they make rounds once a week to say hello.
- - Continue to be upfront with what's happening as it's happening...good, bad, or ugly. We need to know. - Work with supervisors to be sure all members of their team are doing the level of work they should be doing, and this is really important... make sure they are addressing it with the employee if they are not performing as they should be. - It would be nice to just get everyone together for a social event of some type...I'm not sure just what that would be...nothing fancy, something budget friendly, just a time to hang out

together. It's really hard to know what to do...whatever you do some people will be happy; some people won't! Just keep trying!

- Campus wide gatherings of some sort. I know with budget constraints that is hard to do.
- Don't take away flex day Tell us the timeline for when things will get better financially Send us more surveys or ask for our input in this sort of format, so we can feel heard.
- There needs to be more camaraderie between departments and better lines of communication.
- Continue to provide the weekly and or bi weekly updates Continue to be as transparent as possible Use data when presenting, as you have, to support the statements that you are putting out, which you do There is nothing more other than perhaps having some conversations with the more negative folks Maybe it is time to say thanks but no thanks and moving on may make them happier You are trying to save this place and ensure it does not go the way of so many other small private schools This is serious and people need to take it more seriously than they are and less personally than they are But again, I am not a long term person so maybe I am too indifferent on matters
- 1. Communications should be more transparent and timely. Why do we receive separate communications/emails from the President's Office depending on whether we are faculty vs staff? As much as possible, we should all be on the same page (barring AAUP bargaining or legal communications, obviously). 2. The high deductible health care plan in this economy makes accessing care a nightmare. While the HSA option is nice, it doesn't do enough to bridge the gap when the gap is so large. Can we explore options for lower deductible offerings? 3. There is a huge disparity between union employees and non-union employees in terms of feeling safe to speak up. A commitment to open forum for all would help alleviate some of my anxieties about speaking up in different settings. I know PSAC is supposed to be that space, but I don't feel comfortable sharing my concerns or frustrations in that group because I don't feel like they can or will protect me from administrative retaliation.
- 1. Regular social events/mixers for faculty and staff. 2. Opportunity for more Pro Devo workshops/trainings (I know this costs money) 3. Not removing our flex work. So much has already been taken from staff, this may be the tipping point if it is heavily modified/removed.
- 1. University salary increases for those who have not had an increase or title change in years (but have got more work and responsibilities). Those who have got an increase due to NYS minimum mandates should also be highly considered. 2. Explanations and transparency regards to Utica University's 990 filing- specifically schedule j part 1 (1a) in regards to compensation, provide any relevant information regarding these items - Housing allowance or residence for personal use, Travel for companions, Payments for business use of personal residence, Tax indemnification and gross-up payments, Health or social club dues or initiation fees, Discretionary spending account, and finally, Personal services (e.g., maid, chauffeur, chef). Can these perks be explained? These perks and

exorbitant compensation seem a bit much for little ol' Utica University. As well as an explanation as to why we were paying two presidents in the latest filing? As well as how bonus & incentive compensation was awarded. 3. Accountability, hold people accountable for doing their job- it is unfair some people have to show up and work every day and some people do not.

- 1. Investigate prejudice and intolerance in departments, and follow through about support for dei and protecting staff. Having problematic and border unsafe work environment kills morale and only supports individuals that hinder morale for everyone else. This would get qualified individuals to feel comfortable staying and support individuals who are in the university and have felt unseen and unsupported. 2. Opportunities for growth or development. Having no hope for career advancement, especially at entry level, creates dissatisfaction and leads to turnover or resentful staying. Even if it is a title change only or pay change is delayed, this would show appreciation for individuals staying and put the qualified individuals into positions to make a difference. 3. Implement a system of action for reviewing high salary positions held long term. Similar to opportunities for growth, there are people in higher positions who, by holding that position, hinder the college's growth. Faculty have been pressed on retiring when advisable but many staff are working well past retirement without reason and are simply taking a good salary that could be better placed. Similarly, there are high salary positions being held by individuals who are bigoted and/or not doing their job but simply for seniority and time held, they continue in that position unchecked, having been essentially grandfathered in. In my department we have all of this, people working past retirement simply as something to do, racist people and those not doing their job but have positions previously made that are no longer relevant, and even a supervisor that only is in charge of themselves and doesn't have anyone reporting to them.
- 1) Make a \*genuine\* effort to make cuts that don't harm anyone's employment. Instead of using the UPS's CampusShip, work with the USPS or use PirateShip to handle the University's shipping needs. Shipping a 1-pound package through UPS via PirateShip costs less than half of what CampusShip charges. Ask the Tangerine to print in black and white or be online-only for a couple semesters to help save on the cost of ink and printing. These are the types of cuts that should've been sought out from the start, ones that don't threaten anyone's ability to pay rent and are, generally speaking, constructive/beneficial for the university as a whole (or at the least cause an amount of harm far more negligible than laying off several faculty members and forcing staff to take a furlough). 2) Allow departments to hire full-time staff. Any such blockades being enforced have caused several headaches in various offices. Take the recent developments in the library for example. A full-time staff member who worked the late shift left within the first two weeks of the semester, and because they've been blocked from hiring a full-time replacement, the library has had to make multiple changes that have frustrated both their staff and the students as seen in a recent edition of the Tangerine. I'm sure there are

other offices/employees from other offices that hold a similar sentiment/at the least could use some extra part-time help but are also being blocked from hiring even said part-timers. That Utica can initiate and somehow afford a program such as Pioneer Passport (a good thing no doubt) but can't afford to hire full-time staff for some offices, provide even small raises, and has to force staff into furlough is, frankly, insulting given the supposedly exigent circumstances. 3) Do NOT get rid of the FlexWork program. For so many people that is a deal breaker, and I don't think it would be much of a surprise to many if a good chunk of staff were to start looking for work elsewhere in the event it was taken away.

- Stop cutting positions in my department, allow for promotions, bring back retirement contributions
- - better communication between departments. - at times I feel that faculty look down at staff members - not sure how you fix that. - I know that financial hardships are upon us and actions need to be taken and I am ok with the sacrifice. What I need however is better tools at my disposal regarding how to address certain items with students that are directly related to the University's financial situation.
- Have more open meetings, where we can all come together. I think messaging tends to get lost when different meetings take place separately. Faculty might hear one thing, and staff hear another.
- 1. Increased transparency PRIOR TO negative changes such as lay offs, budget cuts, etc.  
2. Meritocracy > Nepotism; don't lay off dedicated and hard-working employees of 10+ years just because they submitted complaints about their supervisor. 3. We've called the ABM & Sodexo employees "family" in various contexts, but they don't seem to get the same benefits and treatment as other employees on campus. They should be included in these conversations, and overall, appreciated a lot more.
- #NAME?
- Cut the fat faster- personnel Cut programs faster Restore \$ and benefits
- 1. Annual raises based on performance evaluations. 2. Working more closely with staff when it comes to initiating things like the furlough so that it is equitable. Not everyone can afford a week without pay, but we may be able to contribute in other ways. Perhaps giving up some hours from vacation time, flex time, or working less hours through the week. 3. Give more attention to new employees and be sure they receive proper onboarding and training within their first 90 days of employment. This would help the employee to feel supported, prepared, and connected with other departments. I was not offered an orientation until I had already been working here a full year. I feel that it was very disrespectful to even be offered an orientation at that point, after having to spend my first year trying to train myself. I had barely any proper training on my responsibilities and ended up having to learn and figure out things on my own most of the time. I felt forgotten about honestly, and most times when I asked someone for help with training I felt like I was a bother because everyone had too much on their plates already. On my first day at Utica, my then supervisor (who no longer works at Utica) took me on a tour,



and asked someone to be my mentor right in front of me. A new employee should already be assigned a mentor planned beforehand as this created an uncomfortable moment for both of us. While I was grateful for my mentor, they were in another department who did duties in a way that wasn't helpful to my department. And so I felt discouraged asking them for help, as it usually led to asking others for help, or "I'm not sure how your department does this, I'm sorry". I'm not putting the blame on the mentor at all, I just want to point out how awkward it was as a new employee. I would never want a new employee to feel how I did when I started, or have had a start to a new position like that. I know it's no individual's fault, but I feel that giving new employee's more attention will boost morale and give each employee a strong start and they will then feel inclined to pay it forward with the next new employee. Everyone I have interacted with at Utica, faculty, staff, students have been nothing less than kind, helpful, and passionate. It's a shame that new employee's wouldn't have a chance to have a stronger start and feel more welcomed as a whole. I apologize for the long rant on this topic, but when I was new, I was too afraid to speak up about this. I would love to see an initiative, committee, something through HR, etc regarding new employee check ins, weekly surveys, individual training sessions, something more for our new staff. Thank you for your time and consideration, and for arranging this survey.

- Get us out of this mess. Be accountable. Be responsive.
- 1. Stop cutting my salary/furloughing me. Stop cutting my retirement benefits. Each time this happens it makes me question if I should jump off the ship before it sinks. I have a family and I need to support them. 2. I'd like to see the promised faculty cuts. Staff have been cut repeatedly and without consent. One of the President's slides showed about 100 staff cuts over the last few years and no cuts to faculty. Staff should not be forced to bear the full force of the University's misfortunes without any impact on faculty. I'm sick of it, frankly. Working with faculty is one of the toughest parts of my job and knowing they do not share the same sacrifices makes me resent them. 3. Please hold meetings with small groups to explain to faculty and offices the importance of always selling Utica. We can't just sell to prospective students, we have to continue to sell to the students who have enrolled here, so they are happy and stay. I often feel effort exerted by various faculty/staff is not comparable where we have certain community members who do an excellent job whereas others show little or no urgency to help a student when asked.
- 1. Better pay/benefits. Not reducing FlexWork. 2. Stability and respect/appreciation for all the work being done, even while noticeably short-staffed and stressed. 3. A honest statement to everyone at the university about the poor decisions in the past leading to where we are now, and appropriate accountability being taken.
- Easy to say restoration of benefits, salaries, annual raises, and retirement contributions but I understand those adjustments were made due to financial realities that are in existence at this moment so impractical. It is my hope that leadership is seeking a course for these to be reimplemented as soon as feasible.



- 1. Stop pushing problem employees from department to department, and instead deal with those who are not performing. More non-performers should have WIPs. It is frustrating to those of us who are working hard. 2. Salaries should match workload and performance. A bigger title should not mean bigger salary. 3. Real transparency (budget issues).
- Find better benefit options, provide more professional development options, better communication strategies
- greater transparency, open communication, actually holding people accountable for their actions and decisions
- . Enhance transparency & communication . Recognize & support employees . Ensuring fairness & consistency for ALL employees
- 1. More forthcoming with decision-making. I understand some things cannot be shared for legal purposes, but it feels bad to hear sweeping changes without ever being invited to the process (staff were never involved in the re-envisioning, despite saying we would be) 2. Work more intentionally across departments on tangible goals/action steps leadership wants to see. The IEP is mostly curriculum-focused, which is understandable, but what mission is the staff following in these times when retention is so critical? 3. Whenever I see senior leadership (President & Provost), they smile, wave, and move on. I don't know if they're afraid of deeper engagement in the moment (which I can understand, given the situations at hand), but it would be nice if they stopped for polite conversation.
- In recent years, it has become increasingly clear that recognition and morale play a critical role in staff engagement, productivity, and overall institutional culture. While many teams and departments across the college are consistently acknowledged for their contributions, some smaller offices often operate behind the scenes with little to no recognition, despite their significant impact on student success and retention. 1. Implement a “Campus Recognition and Appreciation” Program Establish a rotating recognition system that highlights the work of different offices each month. Introduce a “Spotlight Department of the Month” in newsletters, campus announcements, or staff meetings. Include both leadership- and peer-nominated recognitions to ensure equity and broader participation. Feature success stories, student impact highlights, and staff quotes to make the recognition meaningful and personal. 2. Allow Staff and Faculty Summer Access to the Athletic Center and Dome One simple and impactful way to show appreciation would be to allow staff and faculty to use the Athletic Center gym and Dome facilities during the summer months. These facilities are significantly less utilized in the summer, making this a practical and low-impact benefit. Access would promote wellness, reduce burnout, and reinforce the message that the institution values the health and well-being of its employees. This initiative requires no financial investment, only policy flexibility and trust in staff professionalism.
- 1 - Try to reinstitute more positive, non-work, related gatherings (i.e. more informal social gatherings for staff and/or faculty) at the start or end of a semester 2 - Stop talking

about reviewing staff time off (vacation/flex/holidays/etc.) as potential opportunities to resolve institutional problems (staffing, budget, etc.) 3 - Do the easy stuff. Extend summer hours by a week or two, take care of strong staff and faculty that have been with the institution for a number of years, invite them to participate in brainstorming sessions when needed, reinstate access for employees to be able to utilize athletics facilities when students are away and welcome employee families back to campus for events as well

- Create opportunities for professional growth. Reward employees that work hard and go above and beyond.
- If we're going to redesign gen ed, do it in a way that more course offerings from more subjects can count towards gen ed requirements. Right now, I feel like I'm funneling students into the same handful of subjects/classes, which sets the already underenrolled programs up for failure. More leeway in what counts towards students' degrees not only makes my job easier, it makes departments feel more valued when they don't have to cancel classes because of low enrollment and it makes students feel like they're going to an institution that values the liberal arts.
- Re-evaluated the distinction between staff and faculty, we are expected to do much of the same, yet feel like second-rate citizens Re-evaluate benefits on a yearly basis; removing benefits on a whim makes us feel like our job could also be taken on a whim. Provide staff development, as we are also MSN-prepared educators
- 1) Step 1: This form is a step in the right direction. 2) Step 2: Being more considerate of other departments. No more last-minute requests from staff and faculty who have been here for years. 3) Step 3: More communication
- I think it is simple, people are stretched thin covering multiple jobs, areas, and projects because we are in a state of constant change. I think with rates of high turnover it is hard to control this. The yoyo effect with benefits, salary reductions, now a furlough will obviously impact morale. We just got back retirement contributions, now they are gone again. There haven't been consistent yearly raises for years. Ignoring the cuts entirely, people start to feel valued less even if that isn't the first thought that comes to their mind.
- Starting with this climate survey is a good start and long overdue. Please don't make this a one and done. Getting a real pulse on employees should be regularly assessed, not just in the time of crisis.
- 1) What is the plan for analyzing the compression among staff salaries? Directors are not getting the pay bumps every year anymore that lower level staff are so it makes it very difficult to see the value for the extra workload and responsibility when you look at the fact that it is \$20 a day before taxes difference, yet there is 8 years+ experience (especially at this institution) difference. I recognize that the compression is not going to fix itself over night, but is there a plan over the next xx years to get Director salaries to a different level? 2) Can senior leadership offer to come into more meetings and speak with our staff on cuts or money requests (such as staffing) that are being denied. It is

difficult for Director's to consistently be the one to answer the questions/field the concerns and remain unbiased for the decisions above.

- ! ) Publicize Admissions efforts to bring in new student classes - travel (fairs, High Schools), partnerships with 2-year institutions, campus events, leveraging HSscience fairs, HS athletic contests etc.) 2) Publicize how some recent initiatives have paid off/not paid off - tuition reset, graduation guarantees, etc. 3) Provide gatherings/forums for cross department/cross faculty & staff communication/support.
- 1. Honest communications 2. Monthly emails of what leadership team has done this month to fix things 3. Figure out how to fix things or find people that can.
- Provide actual tangible plans to address university shortcomings in the area of student retention, not just saying "its a problem" in the Town Hall presentations. Faculty size has remained largely the same for much of the time that Staff has been reduced over the last year despite the number of students declining, and provide actual plans to address this. If faculty cuts take place, as they should, address the fact that there are many instances of disgruntled professors purposely and openly trying to convince students to leave the school or conveying a negative message to them regarding the state of the University and the changes taking place.
- Cost of living pay increases Restore TIAA contributions Staffing Help
- - Expansion of kudos program - human interest stories in morning mention that highlight emerging performers - devote resources to increase student attendance at events - find ways to bring accomplished, retired staff back in per diem or part time roles (like advancement with [Name]) as this has a tangible, positive affect on workplace morale - special flex release for on- campus exercise - faculty/staff "wall of honor/hall of honor" acts as hall of fame for faculty staff and could be a jolt to positive morale
- I am not confident that anyone in the institution's leadership team even knows my name. It is frustrating to see money spent on insignificant things (such as the phone directory sign in White Hall foyer and excessive signage and promotional material - that is often thrown away or discarded in excess - by admissions for 10+ years for example) but we cannot even order pens or post-it notes for our own use. It would be helpful for leadership team members to know what lower level/entry level employees experience and deal with on a daily basis, even in other departments.
- 1. Show up to events that influence students or staff. 2. Take a real interest in the problems facing various departments. Attend a staff meeting and listen to the challenges departments are facing. 3. Improve the way students are treated during the admissions and financial aid process. Leadership seems absolutely blind to how bad the admissions/financial aid process for a large portion of students.
- 1. Find a way to stop taking financial compensation from employees. 2. Look at other alternative bonuses or something to show people are appreciated. 3. Keep communicating on things, especially what did this power outage do to the budget? What

else can be done, and why cannot some things be denied to be bought if we are having hardships?